# MOP FORMULATION GUIDEBOOK FOR BARMM MINISTRIES, OFFICES, AND AGENCIES

*A Practical Guide for MOP Development Teams, Ministry Personnel, and Government Officers*

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BANGSAMORO GOVERNMENT

BANGSAMORO AUTONOMOUS REGION IN MUSLIM MINDANAO

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# Table of Contents


## About This Guidebook

## About the Author

## Chapter 1 — Introduction: Why MOPs Matter

1.1 What Is a Manual of Operations?
1.2 Why Your MOA Needs a MOP
1.3 Legal Basis: BAA 13 and the Bangsamoro Administrative Code
1.4 Who This Guidebook Is For
1.5 How to Use This Guidebook

## Chapter 2 — Planning and Preparation

2.1 Identifying the Need: Five Triggers for MOP Development
- 2.1.1 New Agency or Office Creation
- 2.1.2 Organizational Restructuring
- 2.1.3 Major Policy or Legal Changes
- 2.1.4 Performance Gaps and Audit Findings
- 2.1.5 Periodic Review Cycle

2.2 Forming the MOP Development Team
- 2.2.1 Team Leader
- 2.2.2 Subject Matter Experts (SMEs)
- 2.2.3 Quality Assurance Specialist
- 2.2.4 Technical Writer
- 2.2.5 Legal Expert
- 2.2.6 Graphic Designer

2.3 Conducting a Needs Assessment
- 2.3.1 Define the Scope
- 2.3.2 Identify Existing Documentation
- 2.3.3 Map Current Processes
- 2.3.4 Identify Gaps and Pain Points
- 2.3.5 Set Objectives and Success Criteria
- 2.3.6 Develop the Work Plan

2.4 Securing Management Buy-In

## Chapter 3 — Information Gathering


3.1 Reviewing Existing Policies and Procedures
- 3.1.1 Collect All Existing Documents
- 3.1.2 Verify Currency and Validity
- 3.1.3 Identify Conflicting Provisions
- 3.1.4 Map Document Hierarchy
- 3.1.5 Note Undocumented Practices
- 3.1.6 Assess Compliance with BAA 13
- 3.1.7 Catalog Forms and Templates
- 3.1.8 Document Findings in a Policy Inventory Matrix

3.2 Conducting Stakeholder Interviews
- 3.2.1 Identify Interview Subjects
- 3.2.2 Prepare Interview Guides
- 3.2.3 Conduct the Interviews
- 3.2.4 Document Responses Systematically
- 3.2.5 Validate Findings Across Sources
- 3.2.6 Identify Informal Workarounds
- 3.2.7 Synthesize Interview Data

3.3 Observing Operations
- 3.3.1 Shadowing Key Personnel
- 3.3.2 Time and Motion Studies
- 3.3.3 Process Mapping from Observation

3.4 Researching Best Practices

3.5 Analyzing Data for Gaps
- 3.5.1 Root Cause Analysis with the 5 Whys
- 3.5.2 Fishbone (Ishikawa) Diagrams
- 3.5.3 Gap Analysis Matrix


## Chapter 4 — Drafting the Manual


4.1 The Nine Standard Chapters
- 4.1.1 Chapter I: Introduction
- 4.1.2 Chapter II: Organizational Structure
- 4.1.3 Chapter III: Human Resource Management
- 4.1.4 Chapter IV: Financial Management
- 4.1.5 Chapter V: Planning and Programming
- 4.1.6 Chapter VI: Service Delivery
- 4.1.7 Chapter VII: Procurement and Property Management
- 4.1.8 Chapter VIII: Reporting and Accountability
- 4.1.9 Chapter IX: Annexes

4.2 Format Standards

4.2.1 Page Layout and Typography
4.2.2 Numbering Systems
4.2.3 Header and Footer Requirements
4.3 Visual Aids and Diagrams
4.3.1 Workflow Diagrams
4.3.2 Organizational Charts
4.3.3 Decision Trees
4.4 Ensuring Consistency Across Chapters

## Chapter 5 — The PRLS MOP Model

5.1 Why the PRLS Format Is the Gold Standard
5.2 Output-Based Organization
5.2.1 The Four Major Output Categories
5.2.2 Mapping Outputs to Mandates
5.3 The Four-Column Workflow Table
5.3.1 Column 1: Step Number
5.3.2 Column 2: Responsible Person/Unit
5.3.3 Column 3: Action/Procedure
5.3.4 Column 4: Output/Form Used
5.4 Hierarchical Approval Flow
5.4.1 Reception Stage
5.4.2 Evaluation and Delegation Stage
5.4.3 Execution Stage
5.4.4 Review Stage
5.4.5 Approval Stage
5.4.6 Delivery Stage
5.5 Standardized Forms
5.5.1 Referral and Action Slips
5.5.2 Transmittal Memoranda
5.5.3 Routing Slips
5.5.4 Tracking Logs
5.6 Complete Sample Procedure: Producing a Legislative Analysis Briefer
5.7 Adapting the PRLS Model for Any MOA

## Chapter 6 — Grounding MOPs in Legal Mandates

6.1 The Central Role of BAA 13
6.1.1 How BAA 13 Defines MOA Structure
6.1.2 Extracting Mandate and Functions
6.2 Cross-Referencing Enabling BAAs
6.2.1 BAA 8: Bangsamoro Women Commission
6.2.2 BAA 9: Bangsamoro Human Rights Commission

6.2.3 BAA 10: Bangsamoro Youth Commission
6.2.4 BAA 17: Bangsamoro Civil Service Code
6.2.5 BAA 18: Bangsamoro Education Code
6.2.6 BAA 35: Bangsamoro Electoral Code
6.2.7 BAA 82: Bangsamoro Labor Code
6.2.8 BAA 84: Budget System Act
6.3 Ensuring BOL Compliance
6.3.1 Aligning with BOL Article V Powers
6.3.2 Respecting Constitutional Boundaries
6.4 The Mandate-to-Procedure Traceability Matrix
6.5 Keeping MOPs Current with Legislative Changes

## Chapter 7 — Quality Standards and Performance Metrics

7.1 Why Quality Criteria Matter in MOPs
7.2 Output Quality Criteria by Type
7.2.1 Policy Outputs (Memoranda, Directives, Guidelines)
7.2.2 Service Delivery Outputs (Certifications, Permits, Approvals)
7.2.3 Research and Analysis Outputs (Briefers, Reports, Studies)
7.2.4 Administrative Outputs (Correspondence, Records, Filings)
7.3 Turnaround Time Standards
7.3.1 Setting Realistic Timelines
7.3.2 Simple, Routine, and Complex Categorization
7.3.3 Escalation Protocols for Delays
7.4 Key Performance Indicators for MOP Effectiveness
7.4.1 Process Efficiency KPIs
7.4.2 Output Quality KPIs
7.4.3 Compliance KPIs
7.4.4 Client Satisfaction KPIs
7.5 Performance Monitoring Systems
7.5.1 Manual Tracking Tools
7.5.2 Digital Monitoring Options
7.5.3 Periodic Performance Reviews

## Chapter 8 — Review, Approval, and Implementation

8.1 Circulating Drafts for Feedback
8.1.1 Internal Review Process
8.1.2 External Expert Review
8.1.3 Managing Conflicting Feedback
8.2 Incorporating Feedback
8.2.1 Feedback Tracking Matrix
8.2.2 Revision Protocols

8.3 Authority Approval
8.3.1 Who Approves the MOP
8.3.2 Approval Documentation
8.4 Staff Orientation and Training
8.4.1 Designing the Orientation Program
8.4.2 Training Sessions by Role
8.4.3 Hands-On Practice with Forms and Workflows
8.5 Rollout Plan
8.5.1 Phased vs. Full Implementation
8.5.2 Distribution and Access
8.5.3 Communication Strategy

## Chapter 9 — Monitoring, Evaluation, and Continuous Improvement

9.1 KPIs for MOP Effectiveness
9.1.1 Adherence Rate
9.1.2 Error and Rework Rate
9.1.3 Average Processing Time
9.1.4 Client Feedback Scores
9.2 User Feedback Mechanisms
9.2.1 Feedback Forms
9.2.2 Focus Group Discussions
9.2.3 Anonymous Suggestion Systems
9.3 Periodic Review Schedule
9.3.1 Quarterly Quick Reviews
9.3.2 Annual Comprehensive Reviews
9.3.3 Triggered Reviews
9.4 Amendment Procedures
9.4.1 Minor Amendments
9.4.2 Major Revisions
9.4.3 Version Control and Change Logs
9.5 Building a Culture of Continuous Improvement

## Chapter 10 — Adapting MOPs by Entity Size

10.1 Why One Size Does Not Fit All
10.2 Provincial MOP (Full 9 Chapters, 80-150 Pages)
10.2.1 When to Use the Full Format
10.2.2 Structure and Content Guide
10.2.3 Sample Chapter Outline
10.3 Division MOP (5-6 Chapters, 40-80 Pages)
10.3.1 When to Use the Division Format
10.3.2 Which Chapters to Include

10.3.3 What to Consolidate
10.4 Office MOP (3-4 Chapters, 20-40 Pages)
10.4.1 When to Use the Office Format
10.4.2 Essential Chapters
10.4.3 Streamlined Procedures
10.5 Decision Matrix: Choosing the Right Format
10.6 Scaling Up: From Office MOP to Provincial MOP

## Glossary of MOP and Governance Terms

# About This Guidebook

This guidebook was written for the people who build and maintain the operating systems of Bangsamoro government. It is designed for daily use – not as a textbook to be read once and shelved, but as a working reference to be consulted at every stage of MOP development.

The guidebook covers the full lifecycle of a Manual of Operations: from the moment a Ministry, Office, or Agency identifies the need for documented procedures, through information gathering, drafting, review, approval, implementation, and continuous improvement. It also addresses the legal grounding of every MOP in BAA 13 (the Bangsamoro Administrative Code) and related enabling legislation, the adaptation of the PRLS MOP format as a gold standard for procedural documentation, and the quality standards that distinguish effective MOPs from shelf documents.

Every provision cited from the Bangsamoro Organic Law (Republic Act No. 11054), BAA 13, and related Bangsamoro Autonomy Acts has been quoted or referenced from the source text. The MOP development principles and format standards reflect established operations management practice adapted to the specific context of Bangsamoro governance, the parliamentary system established under the BOL, and the administrative structure defined by the Bangsamoro Administrative Code.

This guidebook is written to be timeless. It applies equally to MOAs under the Bangsamoro Transition Authority and to MOAs under the elected Bangsamoro Government that will follow. Where procedures or organizational structures are specific to the transition period, the text says so. In all other respects, the guidance here is intended to serve any MOP development team working within the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region, regardless of when they read it.

# About the Author

**Saidamen "Sayeed" R. Mambayao** has worked in governance, legislation, and cooperative development across the Bangsamoro region for over a decade.

Before the establishment of the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region, he served as a Consultant of the Cooperative Development Authority under the former Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao, where he led programs on cooperative development, Islamic finance, and executive leadership. He also served as Secretariat Head and Program Director of the Bangsamoro Executives and Leaders League (BELL), Inc., and held leadership roles in the ARMM Islamic Finance Sub-Cluster and the Bangsamoro Coalition on Social Enterprise.

When the Bangsamoro Transition Authority was established in 2019, he led the development and implementation of two BARMM flagship programs: the Access to Higher and Modern Education (AHME) Scholarship Program under the Ministry of Basic, Higher, and Technical Education, and the Engaging the SK, Empowering the Youth (ESKEY) Program under the Ministry of the Interior and Local Government. He later served as Chief of Staff at the Office of a Member of Parliament, where he assisted on legislative portfolios covering women, youth, children, persons with disabilities, cooperatives, social enterprises, and halal industries. He drafted and reviewed legislative measures on scholarships, cultural heritage preservation, assistance to Other Bangsamoro Communities, and cooperative and social enterprise development. He also served as OIC-Legislative Affairs at the Office of MP Sittie Fahanie S. Uy-Oyod.

He is the Founder of MoroTech and MoroAcademy, social enterprises empowering Bangsamoro organizations and communities through knowledge and technology, and the Founding Chairperson of the Bangsamoro Scholars Association. He also founded the SEED Initiative, a consultancy and training firm focused on cooperative and social enterprise development. He is an Active Citizen and graduate of the British Council's CSO-SEED Business and Investment Readiness Program.

# Introduction

Every government agency exists to deliver results. Citizens apply for permits. Ministries process budgets. Commissions investigate complaints. Offices produce reports. These results do not happen by accident. They happen because people follow procedures – steps that move a request from reception to completion.

A **Manual of Operations (MOP)** captures those procedures in writing. It documents who does what, in what order, using which forms, and to what standard. Without a MOP, your agency runs on memory, habit, and informal agreements. When a key employee transfers, retires, or takes leave, the knowledge walks out the door. New staff guess their way through unfamiliar tasks. Supervisors spend hours explaining processes that should be self-evident. Errors multiply. Delays compound. Citizens lose trust.

This chapter explains why MOPs matter, where their legal authority comes from, and how to use this guidebook.

## 1.1 What Is a Manual of Operations?

A **Manual of Operations** is a comprehensive reference document that defines how a Ministry, Office, or Agency (MOA) performs its functions. It translates your agency's legal mandate into actionable, step-by-step procedures.

A well-built MOP answers five questions for every major output your agency produces:

1. **Who** is responsible at each step?
2. **What** actions must they take?
3. **When** must each step be completed?
4. **What forms** and documents are used?
5. **What standard** determines whether the output is acceptable?

A MOP is not a policy manual. Policy manuals state what your agency will do. A MOP states how your agency will do it. Policy says "The Ministry shall process scholarship applications within 30 days." The MOP says "The Administrative Officer receives the application, logs it in the tracking system, attaches a Referral and Action Slip, and forwards it to the Scholarship Division Chief within one working day."

A MOP is also not an organizational chart. An organizational chart shows who reports to whom. A MOP shows how work flows from person to person to produce a specific output.

> **Key distinction.** A MOP converts your agency's mandate into repeatable, measurable, trainable procedures. It is the operating system of your organization.

## 1.2 Why Your MOA Needs a MOP

Seven problems disappear when your agency has a well-written MOP:

**1. Institutional memory loss.** Government agencies experience frequent personnel movement. Staff transfer between offices. Political appointees change with each administration. Without documented procedures, each departure creates a knowledge vacuum. A MOP preserves institutional knowledge independent of any individual.

**2. Inconsistent service delivery.** When two staff members handle the same process differently, citizens receive unequal treatment. One applicant waits three days; another waits three weeks. A MOP ensures every transaction follows the same steps, regardless of who handles it.

**3. Unclear accountability.** When errors occur, agencies without MOPs struggle to determine responsibility. "That is not my job" becomes a common defense. A MOP assigns a specific responsible person to every step. Accountability is built into the workflow.

**4. Training inefficiency.** New employees in agencies without MOPs learn through oral tradition. Experienced staff invest weeks training replacements. A MOP serves as a self-study resource. New staff read the procedure, study the forms, and shadow the workflow. Training time drops. Consistency increases.

**5. Audit vulnerability.** The Commission on Audit (COA) and internal auditors evaluate whether agencies follow established procedures. An agency without a MOP has no baseline against which auditors can measure compliance. Audit findings become difficult to contest.

**6. Process bottlenecks.** Without documented workflows, bottlenecks hide in plain sight. A MOP maps each step with its responsible person and expected turnaround time. Bottlenecks become visible and fixable.

**7. Legal exposure.** BAA 13 (the Bangsamoro Administrative Code) requires MOAs to operate within defined structures and procedures. An agency that cannot demonstrate documented standard operating procedures is operationally and legally exposed.

## 1.3 Legal Basis: BAA 13 and the Bangsamoro Administrative Code

The legal foundation for MOPs in the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region rests primarily on **Bangsamoro Autonomy Act No. 13**, also known as the **Bangsamoro Administrative Code**. BAA 13 establishes the organizational framework for all Ministries, Offices, and Agencies in the BARMM. It defines:

- The **structure** of the Bangsamoro Government's executive departments
- The **mandate and functions** of each Ministry
- The **organizational hierarchy** from Minister to Division Chief to staff
- The **administrative systems** governing human resources, finance, planning, procurement, and reporting

BAA 13 creates the skeleton. Your MOP adds the muscles, nerves, and blood. Every procedure you document in your MOP should trace back to a specific mandate or function defined in BAA 13 or in the enabling BAA that created your agency.

Beyond BAA 13, several other Bangsamoro Autonomy Acts create specific agencies and define their mandates:

| BAA | Agency/Subject | MOP Relevance |
|---|---|---|
| BAA 8 | Bangsamoro Women Commission (BWC) | Defines BWC mandate, functions, and organizational structure |
| BAA 9 | Bangsamoro Human Rights Commission | Defines BHRC mandate, investigative procedures, and reporting requirements |
| BAA 10 | Bangsamoro Youth Commission (BYC) | Defines BYC mandate, youth development programs, and coordination functions |
| BAA 17 | Bangsamoro Civil Service Code | Governs HR procedures: recruitment, appointment, promotion, discipline |
| BAA 18 | Bangsamoro Education Code | Defines MBHTE mandate and education delivery procedures |
| BAA 35 | Bangsamoro Electoral Code | Governs electoral processes and BARMM election administration |

| BAA | Agency/Subject | MOP Relevance |
|---|---|---|
| BAA 82 | Bangsamoro Labor Code | Defines labor standards, employment procedures, and worker protections |
| BAA 84 | Budget System Act | Governs budget preparation, execution, and accountability procedures |

The **Bangsamoro Organic Law (Republic Act No. 11054)** sits above all BAAs. It defines the powers of the Bangsamoro Government under Article V. Every MOA exists because the BOL authorized its creation, directly or through delegation to the BTA Parliament. Your MOP must operate within the constitutional and statutory boundaries that the BOL establishes.

> **Bangsamoro context.** Your MOP is not just an internal management tool. It is your agency's compliance document. When COA auditors, Parliamentary oversight committees, or the Chief Minister's office asks how your agency operates, the MOP is your authoritative answer.

## 1.4 Who This Guidebook Is For

This guidebook serves four audiences:

**MOP Development Teams.** You are the primary audience. This guidebook walks you through every phase of MOP creation: planning, information gathering, drafting, review, approval, implementation, and continuous improvement. Follow the chapters in order for a first-time MOP. Use individual chapters as references when revising an existing MOP.

**Ministry and Agency Heads.** You commission and approve MOPs. This guidebook helps you understand what to expect from your MOP Development Team, how to evaluate draft MOPs, and what standards to enforce. Chapters 7 (Quality Standards) and 8 (Review and Approval) are especially relevant.

**Division Chiefs and Unit Heads.** You implement MOPs daily. This guidebook shows you how your procedures should be documented, what the PRLS MOP format looks like, and how to propose amendments when procedures need updating. Chapter 5 (The PRLS MOP Model) is your primary reference.

**Staff Officers and Administrative Personnel.** You execute the procedures. This guidebook helps you understand why your procedures are structured the way they are, what forms to use, and how your work connects to the larger workflow. Chapter 5 gives you concrete examples of the workflow tables you will follow.

## 1.5 How to Use This Guidebook

This guidebook follows the lifecycle of a MOP from conception to continuous improvement. The chapters are designed to be read in sequence for a first-time MOP development effort, then consulted individually as references.

**Chapters 1-3** cover the foundation: understanding what a MOP is, planning your development effort, and gathering the information you need.

**Chapter 4** guides you through drafting the nine standard chapters that every MOP should contain.

**Chapter 5** is the most important chapter in this guidebook. It presents the **PRLS MOP Model** – the format used by the Policy Research and Legal Services (PRLS) of the Bangsamoro Parliament – as the gold standard for procedural documentation. This chapter shows you exactly how to build output-based workflow tables with hierarchical approval chains. Study this chapter carefully. Use its templates.

**Chapter 6** shows you how to ground every procedure in your MOP in the legal mandates established by BAA 13 and related legislation. A MOP that is not traceable to its legal basis is a MOP that can be challenged.

**Chapter 7** addresses what many existing MOPs lack: explicit quality standards and performance metrics for every output your agency produces.

**Chapters 8-9** cover the review, approval, rollout, and continuous improvement processes that keep your MOP alive and current.

**Chapter 10** provides scaling guidance. Not every entity needs a 150-page MOP. This chapter shows you how to adapt the format for full Ministries, Divisions, and individual Offices.

Throughout this guidebook, you will find:

- **Tables** that organize complex information for quick reference
- **Blockquotes** that highlight legal provisions and Bangsamoro-specific context
- **Step-by-step procedures** that you can adapt directly for your MOP
- **Sample workflow tables** in the PRLS format that you can customize for your outputs

Begin with Chapter 2 if you are starting a new MOP. Turn to Chapter 5 if you need to understand the PRLS format immediately. Consult Chapter 10 if you need to determine the right scope for your entity.

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*Back to Table of Contents*

# 02

## Planning and Preparation

A MOP built without planning is a MOP built twice. This chapter covers the three foundational steps before you write a single procedure: identifying your triggers, forming your team, and conducting a needs assessment.

## 2.1 Identifying the Need: Five Triggers for MOP Development

Five situations trigger the need for MOP development or revision. Recognizing your trigger helps you scope the effort correctly.

### 2.1.1 New Agency or Office Creation

When the BTA Parliament enacts a BAA that creates a new agency – such as BAA 8 creating the Bangsamoro Women Commission or BAA 10 creating the Bangsamoro Youth Commission – that agency starts with a mandate but no operational procedures. The enabling BAA defines what the agency must do. The MOP defines how.

**Action required.** Develop a complete MOP covering all nine standard chapters. Begin with the agency's mandate as defined in the enabling BAA, then map every mandated function to specific procedures.

### 2.1.2 Organizational Restructuring

When an existing MOA undergoes restructuring – new divisions created, functions transferred, reporting lines changed – existing MOPs become outdated. Procedures reference positions that no longer exist or divisions that have been merged.

**Action required.** Conduct a gap analysis comparing the current MOP against the new organizational structure. Revise affected chapters. A full rewrite is often more efficient than patching multiple chapters.

### 2.1.3 Major Policy or Legal Changes

When new BAAs, executive orders, or administrative directives change how your agency operates, your MOP must reflect those changes. BAA 84 (Budget System Act), for example, changed budget preparation procedures for every MOA. Any MOP written before BAA 84 needs a revised Financial Management chapter.

**Action required.** Identify all procedures affected by the new legislation. Draft revised procedures. Route through the amendment process described in Chapter 9.

### 2.1.4 Performance Gaps and Audit Findings

When COA audit reports, internal audits, or performance reviews reveal procedural weaknesses – delays, errors, missing documentation, unclear accountability – these findings point to MOP deficiencies.

**Action required.** Map each audit finding to a specific MOP procedure. Determine whether the procedure is missing, unclear, or not being followed. Revise accordingly.

### 2.1.5 Periodic Review Cycle

Every MOP should be reviewed at least once every three years, even without a triggering event. Operations evolve. Informal workarounds become standard practice. Forms change. Technology upgrades alter workflows. A periodic review catches these drifts before they become problems.

**Action required.** Schedule the review. Use the review process described in Chapter 9. Update as needed.

## 2.2 Forming the MOP Development Team

A MOP is not a solo project. Building a credible, implementable MOP requires diverse expertise. Assign six roles to your MOP Development Team. One person may fill multiple roles in smaller agencies, but every role must be covered.

### 2.2.1 Team Leader

The **Team Leader** manages the MOP development process from start to finish. This person sets the timeline, assigns tasks, resolves disagreements, and presents the final draft to the approving authority.

**Ideal profile.** A senior officer (Division Chief or equivalent) who understands the agency's operations across divisions. The Team Leader needs authority to convene meetings, request documents, and assign deadlines.

**Responsibilities:** - Develop and manage the MOP work plan - Coordinate all team activities - Resolve conflicting inputs from SMEs - Present progress reports to the agency head - Submit the final draft for approval

### 2.2.2 Subject Matter Experts (SMEs)

**Subject Matter Experts** are the people who know how things actually work. They perform the procedures daily or supervise those who do. Every division or major functional area should have at least one SME on the team.

**Ideal profile.** Staff officers, section chiefs, or senior technical staff with three or more years of experience in their functional area.

**Responsibilities:** - Describe current procedures accurately and completely - Identify undocumented practices and informal workarounds - Validate drafted procedures for accuracy - Test procedures for completeness and feasibility

### 2.2.3 Quality Assurance Specialist

The **Quality Assurance (QA) Specialist** checks the MOP for internal consistency, completeness, and clarity. This person ensures that every procedure has a responsible person, every form is referenced correctly, and no steps are missing.

**Ideal profile.** An officer with attention to detail and experience in document review, internal audit, or quality management.

**Responsibilities:** - Review all drafted procedures for completeness - Check cross-references between chapters - Verify that every referenced form exists in the Annexes - Ensure consistent terminology throughout the MOP - Conduct the final pre-approval quality review

### 2.2.4 Technical Writer

The **Technical Writer** transforms the SMEs' descriptions into clear, consistent, properly formatted procedures. This person enforces the format standards described in Chapter 4 and applies the PRLS MOP Model described in Chapter 5.

**Ideal profile.** An officer with strong writing skills and experience in technical documentation. Familiarity with the PRLS format is a significant advantage.

**Responsibilities:** - Convert SME inputs into standardized procedure formats - Apply consistent numbering, headings, and layout - Build workflow tables in the four-column format - Write introductory and transitional text for each chapter - Ensure readability for the target audience

### 2.2.5 Legal Expert

The **Legal Expert** ensures that every procedure in the MOP is grounded in the agency's legal mandate. This person traces procedures to BAA 13, the enabling BAA, and other relevant legislation. They also flag procedures that may conflict with existing laws or regulations.

**Ideal profile.** A legal officer, attorney, or officer with legal training who is familiar with the Bangsamoro legal framework.

**Responsibilities:** - Verify that all procedures trace to a legal mandate - Build the mandate-to-procedure traceability matrix (Chapter 6) - Flag potential legal conflicts - Review the MOP for compliance with BAA 13, BAA 17, and other relevant BAAs - Advise on regulatory and policy implications

### 2.2.6 Graphic Designer

The **Graphic Designer** creates the visual elements that make the MOP usable: organizational charts, workflow diagrams, decision trees, and page layouts.

**Ideal profile.** An officer or consultant with graphic design skills and experience producing government documents.

**Responsibilities:** - Create organizational charts based on the agency's staffing pattern - Design workflow diagrams for key procedures - Produce decision trees for complex processes - Apply consistent visual formatting throughout the document - Prepare the final layout for printing and digital distribution

## 2.3 Conducting a Needs Assessment

Before gathering detailed information, conduct a structured needs assessment. This assessment defines the scope of your MOP and identifies the major gaps your MOP must address. Follow six steps.

### 2.3.1 Define the Scope

Determine what the MOP will cover. A Ministry-level MOP covers all divisions and functions. A Division MOP covers only that division's operations. An Office MOP covers a single office. See Chapter 10 for guidance on choosing the right scope.

Document your scope decision in writing. State clearly what is included and what is excluded. Share this with the agency head for confirmation before proceeding.

### 2.3.2 Identify Existing Documentation

Collect everything your agency already has: existing MOPs (even outdated ones), office orders, special orders, memoranda, standard operating procedures, process flowcharts, forms, templates, and checklists. Catalog each document with its date, author, and current status (active, superseded, or draft).

Many BARMM agencies have partial documentation scattered across divisions. A complete inventory prevents you from duplicating work that already exists.

### 2.3.3 Map Current Processes

Before you can document procedures, you need to understand what people actually do – not what they are supposed to do, but what they do in practice. Map current processes through observation and interviews. Chapter 3 provides detailed methods.

At the needs assessment stage, focus on high-level process maps: major inputs, key steps, decision points, and final outputs. Save detailed step-by-step mapping for the information gathering phase.

### 2.3.4 Identify Gaps and Pain Points

Compare your existing documentation against your current processes. Look for five types of gaps:

1. **Missing procedures.** Functions your agency performs that have no documented procedure.
2. **Outdated procedures.** Written procedures that no longer match actual practice.
3. **Conflicting procedures.** Two or more documents that prescribe different steps for the same process.
4. **Incomplete procedures.** Written procedures that skip steps, omit forms, or fail to assign responsibility.
5. **Undocumented decisions.** Points in the workflow where staff make judgment calls without written criteria.

Document each gap. Rate its severity (critical, major, or minor). Prioritize critical and major gaps for immediate attention in the MOP.

### 2.3.5 Set Objectives and Success Criteria

Define what success looks like. Your MOP objectives should be specific and measurable. Examples:

- "Document all 15 service delivery procedures with complete workflow tables."
- "Reduce average processing time for permit applications by 20% within six months of MOP implementation."
- "Achieve 100% compliance with form usage within three months of MOP rollout."
- "Train all 45 staff members on the new MOP within 30 days of approval."

Write these objectives into your work plan. Use them to measure success during the monitoring phase (Chapter 9).

### 2.3.6 Develop the Work Plan

Build a detailed work plan with the following elements:

| Element | Description |
|---|---|
| **Activities** | Every major task from information gathering to final approval |
| **Responsible person** | The team member assigned to each activity |

| Element | Description |
|---|---|
| **Timeline** | Start and end dates for each activity |
| **Deliverables** | The specific output expected from each activity |
| **Dependencies** | Activities that must be completed before others can begin |
| **Resources** | Budget, equipment, software, and other resources needed |

A typical first-time MOP development effort for a Ministry takes 8-12 weeks. A Division MOP takes 4-8 weeks. An Office MOP takes 2-4 weeks. These timelines assume a dedicated team. If team members are working on MOP development alongside their regular duties, add 50% to the timeline.

## 2.4 Securing Management Buy-In

A MOP without management support is a MOP that collects dust. Before beginning the information gathering phase, present your work plan to the agency head. Cover three points:

**1. The problem.** Describe the specific operational issues your MOP will address. Use audit findings, complaint data, or processing delay statistics if available. Management responds to evidence, not abstractions.

**2. The solution.** Explain what the MOP will contain, how it will be developed, and how long it will take. Reference the PRLS MOP Model (Chapter 5) as the format standard. Show a sample workflow table if possible.

**3. The ask.** State what you need: time allocation for team members, access to documents and personnel, budget for printing and design, and a commitment to approve and implement the final product.

Document management's approval in a memorandum or office order. This document protects your team when you need to pull SMEs away from their regular duties for interviews and review sessions.

> **Practical tip.** Schedule a 30-minute briefing with the agency head. Bring a one-page summary of your work plan, a list of team members, and one example of an operational gap that the MOP will fix. Keep the briefing focused on results, not process.

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*Back to Table of Contents*

# 03

## Information Gathering

The quality of your MOP depends on the quality of your information. Rushing through this phase produces procedures that describe an idealized version of your agency – not the agency that actually exists. This chapter provides systematic methods for collecting accurate, complete information.

## 3.1 Reviewing Existing Policies and Procedures

Begin with what already exists on paper. Every BARMM agency has some form of documentation, even if it is scattered, outdated, or incomplete. A thorough review of existing documents prevents you from reinventing procedures that already work and reveals gaps that need attention.

### 3.1.1 Collect All Existing Documents

Request the following from every division and office within your MOP's scope:

- Current MOPs or standard operating procedures (SOPs)
- Office orders and special orders
- Memoranda and circulars
- Process flowcharts
- Forms, templates, and checklists
- Training materials and orientation guides
- Job descriptions and position descriptions
- Previous audit reports and management letters
- Organizational charts (current and historical)

Cast a wide net. Check physical filing cabinets and digital drives. Ask long-serving staff where documents are stored. Many agencies discover useful documentation buried in archives that current staff have never seen.

### 3.1.2 Verify Currency and Validity

For each document you collect, verify three things:

1. **Date.** When was it last updated? Documents older than three years are likely outdated.
2. **Authority.** Who approved it? Documents without clear approval authority have uncertain status.

3. **Status.** Is it currently in effect, or has it been superseded by a newer document?

Mark each document as current, outdated, or unknown. Focus your detailed review on current documents, but keep outdated ones for reference – they often contain useful procedural detail that newer documents omit.

### 3.1.3 Identify Conflicting Provisions

When two documents prescribe different steps for the same process, you have a conflict. Conflicts create confusion. Staff follow whichever version they encountered first, producing inconsistent results.

Document each conflict in a comparison table:

| Process | Document A | Document B | Conflict |
|---|---|---|---|
| Leave application | Office Order No. 12: Submit to Division Chief | Memo No. 45: Submit to Admin Officer | Different initial recipient |
| Procurement request | SOP v1: Three quotes required | SOP v2: Three quotes for purchases above 50,000 | Different threshold |

Resolve conflicts during the drafting phase (Chapter 4). For now, document them accurately.

### 3.1.4 Map Document Hierarchy

Establish which documents take precedence. The hierarchy for BARMM agencies is:

1. **Republic Act No. 11054** (Bangsamoro Organic Law) – supreme authority
2. **Bangsamoro Autonomy Acts** (BAA 13, BAA 17, BAA 84, etc.) – legislative mandates
3. **Executive Orders and Administrative Orders** – executive directives
4. **Department Orders and Memorandum Circulars** – Ministry-level directives
5. **Office Orders and SOPs** – operational-level directives

When lower-level documents conflict with higher-level ones, the higher-level document controls. Your MOP must comply with all documents above it in the hierarchy.

### 3.1.5 Note Undocumented Practices

Many agencies operate through undocumented practices – procedures that staff follow by convention but that exist nowhere in writing. These practices are not necessarily wrong. Some represent efficient adaptations to real-world conditions. Others represent unauthorized shortcuts.

Identify undocumented practices by comparing written procedures against observed practice. Note each one for evaluation during the drafting phase. Decide whether to formalize, modify, or eliminate each practice.

### 3.1.6 Assess Compliance with BAA 13

Compare your agency's existing documents against the organizational structure and functions defined in BAA 13. Check whether:

- Your organizational chart matches the structure prescribed by BAA 13
- Your documented functions align with the mandates listed in BAA 13
- Your procedures reference the correct legal authorities
- Your forms and templates comply with administrative requirements

Flag any discrepancies. These must be resolved in the new MOP.

### 3.1.7 Catalog Forms and Templates

Create a complete inventory of every form and template your agency uses. For each form, record:

| Field | Description |
|---|---|
| **Form name** | Official name of the form |
| **Form number** | Assigned number (if any) |
| **Purpose** | What the form is used for |
| **Origin** | Who created it and when |
| **Frequency** | How often it is used |
| **Location** | Where blank copies are stored |
| **Status** | Current, modified, or obsolete |

This inventory becomes the basis for the Annexes chapter of your MOP (Chapter IX in the standard structure).

### 3.1.8 Document Findings in a Policy Inventory Matrix

Consolidate all findings from steps 3.1.1 through 3.1.7 into a single Policy Inventory Matrix:

| Document Title | Date | Authority | Status | Scope | Conflicts | BAA 13 Compliance | Not |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| SOP on Procurement | 2022-03-15 | Admin Division Chief | Current | Division-wide | Conflicts with BAA 84 threshold | Partial | Nee upd BAA |
| Office Order No. 12 | 2020-07-01 | Minister | Outdated | Ministry-wide | None identified | Compliant | Sup by C 34 |

This matrix becomes your primary reference for the drafting phase.

## 3.2 Conducting Stakeholder Interviews

Documents tell you what should happen. People tell you what actually happens. Stakeholder interviews bridge the gap between written procedures and operational reality.

### 3.2.1 Identify Interview Subjects

Interview at least one person from each of these categories:

- **Agency head or deputy** – strategic perspective, priorities, and expectations
- **Division chiefs** – division-level operations, inter-division coordination
- **Section chiefs or unit heads** – day-to-day workflow management
- **Staff officers** – hands-on procedural execution
- **Administrative staff** – records management, filing, correspondence flow
- **Clients or service recipients** – external perspective on service delivery
- **Partner agencies** – inter-agency coordination procedures

Prioritize people with the most direct knowledge of procedures. A division chief may know the policy, but a staff officer knows the actual steps.

### 3.2.2 Prepare Interview Guides

Build a semi-structured interview guide with questions organized by topic. Use open-ended questions that encourage detailed responses:

**Process questions:** - "Walk me through what happens when you receive a [specific request]." - "What is the first thing you do when this document arrives on your desk?" - "How do you know when this task is complete?"

**Responsibility questions:** - "Who decides whether to approve or reject this request?" - "What happens when the usual approver is not available?" - "Who do you go to when you are unsure how to handle something?"

**Form and document questions:** - "What forms do you use for this process?" - "Do you ever modify the form or add extra information?" - "Where do you file the completed form?"

**Problem questions:** - "What is the most common delay in this process?" - "What causes the most errors?" - "If you could change one thing about this procedure, what would it be?"

### 3.2.3 Conduct the Interviews

Schedule 30-60 minutes per interview. Conduct interviews in the interviewee's workspace whenever possible – this allows them to show you the actual forms, files, and tools they use.

Follow these guidelines:

- Begin by explaining the purpose of the interview and how the information will be used
- Ask the interviewee to describe their processes step by step, as if teaching a new employee
- Listen more than you talk
- Ask follow-up questions when steps seem unclear or incomplete
- Request copies of filled-out forms as examples
- Thank the interviewee and explain the next steps

### 3.2.4 Document Responses Systematically

Record each interview using a standard template:

| Field | Content |
|---|---|
| **Interviewee** | Name, position, division |
| **Date** | Interview date |
| **Interviewer** | Your name |
| **Topic** | Process or function discussed |
| **Key findings** | Bullet-point summary of main points |
| **Forms mentioned** | List of forms and documents referenced |
| **Gaps identified** | Missing steps, unclear responsibilities, bottlenecks |
| **Recommendations** | Interviewee's suggestions for improvement |

### 3.2.5 Validate Findings Across Sources

Cross-check what one interviewee tells you against what others say. When three people describe the same process differently, you have discovered a standardization gap that your MOP must address.

Create a validation matrix:

| Process Step | Interviewee A | Interviewee B | Interviewee C | Consistent? |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Who receives the request? | Admin Officer | Division Secretary | Guard on duty | No |
| Who assigns the task? | Division Chief | Section Head | Division Chief | Mostly |
| How long does review take? | 1-2 days | 3-5 days | Same day | No |

Inconsistencies are not problems to hide. They are problems to solve. Document them honestly. Resolve them during drafting through consultation with the approving authority.

### 3.2.6 Identify Informal Workarounds

Every agency has workarounds – informal procedures that staff use to get things done when the formal process is too slow, unclear, or impractical. Common workarounds include:

- Verbal approvals before written documentation
- Personal follow-up calls to track document movement
- Unofficial forms created by staff to fill gaps
- Informal queuing systems based on personal relationships
- Shortcut routing that bypasses review steps

Identify these workarounds without judgment. Some workarounds are efficient innovations that should be formalized. Others are risky shortcuts that should be eliminated. The drafting phase is where you make those decisions.

### 3.2.7 Synthesize Interview Data

After completing all interviews, consolidate your findings into a synthesis report organized by functional area:

1. **Common themes** across all interviews
2. **Process descriptions** as described by practitioners (not as written in documents)
3. **Gaps and inconsistencies** between documented and actual procedures
4. **Recommended improvements** from staff
5. **Forms and tools** in actual use

This synthesis becomes a primary input to the drafting phase.

## 3.3 Observing Operations

Interviews capture what people say they do. Observation captures what they actually do. People are not dishonest – they simply cannot articulate every micro-step in their workflow from memory. Observation fills those gaps.

### 3.3.1 Shadowing Key Personnel

**Shadowing** means following a staff member through their workday, observing how they handle tasks from start to finish. Shadow at least one person per key procedure.

**How to shadow effectively:**

1. Explain your purpose before you begin. Assure the person that you are observing the process, not evaluating their performance.
2. Sit or stand where you can see what they are doing without interfering.
3. Note every step, including steps they do automatically and would not mention in an interview.
4. Record the time each step takes.
5. Note tools, forms, and systems they use.
6. Ask clarifying questions during natural pauses – not during the task.
7. Debrief with the person after the observation. Ask, “Did I miss anything? Was today typical?”

### 3.3.2 Time and Motion Studies

A **time and motion study** measures how long each step in a procedure takes. This data is essential for setting realistic turnaround time standards in your MOP (Chapter 7).

For each procedure you study, record:

| Step | Action | Start Time | End Time | Duration | Wait Time | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Receive document | 9:00 | 9:02 | 2 min | 0 | Logged in registry |
| 2 | | 9:02 | 9:05 | 3 min | 0 | |

| Step | Action | Start Time | End Time | Duration | Wait Time | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Attach action slip | | | | | Standard form used |
| 3 | Route to Division Chief | 9:05 | 9:05 | 0 min | 45 min | Waited for chief's arrival |
| 4 | Chief reviews and assigns | 9:50 | 10:05 | 15 min | 0 | Reviewed with section head |

Separate **active time** (time spent doing work) from **wait time** (time the document sits idle). In most government processes, wait time accounts for 60-80% of total processing time. This is where efficiency improvements hide.

### 3.3.3 Process Mapping from Observation

Convert your observations into visual process maps. Use simple notation:

- **Rectangle** – action step ("Review document")
- **Diamond** – decision point ("Is document complete?")
- **Arrow** – direction of flow
- **Oval** – start or end point
- **Parallel lines** – wait or delay

Process maps from observation often look different from process maps derived from interviews or documents. The differences reveal where actual practice has drifted from intended practice.

## 3.4 Researching Best Practices

Look beyond your agency. Other BARMM agencies, national government agencies, and international organizations have developed MOPs for similar functions. Study their approaches.

**Sources to check:**

- **PRLS MOP.** The Policy Research and Legal Services MOP is the gold standard within the Bangsamoro Parliament. Chapter 5 analyzes its format in detail.
- **Other BARMM MOAs.** Request copies of MOPs from peer agencies. The Ministry of the Interior and Local Government (MILG) and the Ministry of Finance, Budget, and Management (MFBM) often have well-developed operational manuals.
- **National government agencies.** The Department of Budget and Management (DBM) and the Civil Service Commission (CSC) publish operations manuals and citizen's charters that provide useful formatting models.
- **International frameworks.** ISO 9001 (Quality Management Systems) provides a structured approach to documenting processes that many government agencies worldwide follow.

Adapt best practices to your context. Copy the format, not the content. Your procedures must reflect your agency's specific mandate, organizational structure, and operating environment.

## 3.5 Analyzing Data for Gaps

After gathering information from documents, interviews, and observation, analyze your data to identify root causes of operational problems. Three tools are particularly useful.

### 3.5.1 Root Cause Analysis with the 5 Whys

The **5 Whys** technique asks "why?" repeatedly until you reach the root cause of a problem. It prevents you from addressing symptoms instead of causes.

**Example:**

| Why | Question | Answer |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Why are procurement requests delayed? | Because approvals take too long |
| 2 | Why do approvals take too long? | Because the approving officer is often unavailable |
| 3 | Why is the approving officer unavailable? | Because they travel frequently for field work |
| 4 | Why is there no alternate approver? | Because the delegation of authority memo does not include procurement |
| 5 | Why does the delegation memo not include procurement? | Because it was written before procurement was decentralized to divisions |

**Root cause:** The delegation of authority memo is outdated. The fix is not to speed up approvals but to update the delegation memo to include a designated alternate approver for procurement requests.

Your MOP should address the root cause: include a provision for alternate approvers and reference the updated delegation of authority.

### 3.5.2 Fishbone (Ishikawa) Diagrams

A **fishbone diagram** maps all possible causes of a problem into categories. The standard categories for government processes are:

- **People** – staffing levels, skills, availability
- **Process** – steps, sequencing, decision points
- **Policy** – rules, regulations, mandates
- **Technology** – systems, tools, equipment
- **Resources** – budget, materials, facilities
- **Communication** – information flow, coordination

Draw the problem at the head of the fish. Draw each category as a bone. List specific causes under each category. This visual tool helps your team see the full picture and prioritize which causes your MOP can address.

### 3.5.3 Gap Analysis Matrix

Consolidate your findings into a Gap Analysis Matrix that directly feeds the drafting phase:

| Functional Area | Current State | Desired State | Gap | Root Cause | MOP Chapter Affected |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Document routing | Verbal routing, no tracking | Referral and Action Slip system | No standard routing form | No form exists | Ch. VI: Service Delivery |
| Budget preparation | Each division uses different format | Standardized budget template | Inconsistent formats | No template exists | Ch. IV: Financial Management |
| Staff onboarding | Informal orientation by colleagues | Structured 5-day orientation | No orientation program | No SOP for onboarding | Ch. III: HR Management |
| Procurement | Three quotes for all amounts | Three quotes above 50,000; | Over-documentation | Outdated SOP | Ch. VII: Procurement |

| Functional Area | Current State | Desired State | Gap | Root Cause | MOP Chapter Affected |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | simplified below | | | |

This matrix becomes your drafting roadmap. Each gap maps to a specific chapter and procedure in your MOP. When the matrix is complete, you are ready to begin drafting.

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*Back to Table of Contents*

# 04

## Drafting the Manual

You have planned your effort, formed your team, and gathered your information. Now you write. This chapter guides you through the nine standard chapters that every MOP should contain, the format standards that make your MOP professional and usable, and the visual aids that bring procedures to life.

## 4.1 The Nine Standard Chapters

Every MOP for a BARMM Ministry, Office, or Agency should follow a nine-chapter structure. This structure ensures completeness and allows readers to find information predictably across agencies. When an auditor reviews the MILG MOP and then picks up the MBHTE MOP, they should find the same chapter structure with agency-specific content.

### 4.1.1 Chapter I: Introduction

The Introduction chapter provides context. It answers: What does this agency do? Why does this MOP exist? How should readers use it?

**Required content:**

- **Agency background.** Brief history, creation, and evolution. Reference the enabling BAA.
- **Vision, mission, and mandate.** Taken verbatim from the agency's official documents and BAA 13.
- **Purpose of the MOP.** State clearly why this MOP was developed and what it replaces.
- **Scope and coverage.** Define what the MOP covers and what it does not cover.
- **Legal basis.** List all laws, BAAs, executive orders, and regulations that authorize the agency's operations and govern the procedures in the MOP.
- **How to use this MOP.** Brief instructions for readers.
- **Amendment procedures.** How users can request changes to the MOP.
- **Definitions of terms.** Key terms used throughout the MOP, defined once and used consistently.

**Length guide:** 5-10 pages.

### 4.1.2 Chapter II: Organizational Structure

This chapter documents the agency's structure from the highest position to the lowest. It makes reporting relationships, functional responsibilities, and staffing patterns explicit.

**Required content:**

- **Organizational chart.** A visual diagram showing every division, section, and unit with reporting lines.
- **Functional chart.** A chart showing which functions belong to which organizational unit.
- **Position descriptions.** For each position, state the title, salary grade, reporting relationship, and primary duties. Align with BAA 17 (Bangsamoro Civil Service Code) requirements.
- **Staffing pattern.** The authorized number of positions per unit, distinguishing between filled and vacant positions.
- **Delegation of authority.** Who acts when the primary authority is absent, for each key approval function.

**Length guide:** 8-15 pages.

> **BAA 13 connection.** BAA 13 prescribes the organizational structure for each Ministry. Your organizational chart must be consistent with BAA 13. If your actual structure differs from what BAA 13 prescribes, document the variance and cite the authority for the deviation (e.g., an executive order or reorganization plan).

### 4.1.3 Chapter III: Human Resource Management

This chapter documents all HR procedures: recruitment, appointment, onboarding, leave management, performance evaluation, training, discipline, and separation.

**Required content:**

- **Recruitment and selection procedures.** How positions are advertised, applications screened, interviews conducted, and appointments processed. Reference BAA 17 (Bangsamoro Civil Service Code).
- **Onboarding procedures.** What new employees receive, learn, and complete in their first week.
- **Leave management.** Types of leave, application procedures, approval authorities, and tracking.

- **Performance evaluation.** Performance appraisal cycle, forms, rating system, and feedback procedures.
- **Training and development.** How training needs are identified, programs selected, and participation tracked.
- **Discipline.** Administrative disciplinary procedures. Reference BAA 17, Book V (Accountability of Public Officers and Employees).
- **Separation procedures.** Resignation, retirement, transfer, and termination processing.

**Length guide:** 15-25 pages.

### 4.1.4 Chapter IV: Financial Management

This chapter documents all financial procedures: budget preparation, fund management, disbursement, collections, and financial reporting.

**Required content:**

- **Budget preparation.** Annual budget cycle, roles, timelines, and forms. Reference BAA 84 (Budget System Act).
- **Fund management.** How funds are received, recorded, and managed.
- **Disbursement procedures.** How payments are processed, including voucher preparation, pre-audit, approval, and release.
- **Cash advance and liquidation.** Procedures for cash advances and their timely liquidation.
- **Revenue collection.** If applicable, how your agency collects and records revenue.
- **Financial reporting.** Monthly, quarterly, and annual financial reports: who prepares them, who reviews them, who submits them, and to whom.

**Length guide:** 10-20 pages.

### 4.1.5 Chapter V: Planning and Programming

This chapter documents how the agency plans its work, sets targets, and programs its activities.

**Required content:**

- **Annual work planning.** How the agency develops its annual operational plan, aligned with the Bangsamoro Development Plan (BDP 2023-2028).

- **Program/project development.** How new programs, projects, activities, and services (PPAS) are conceived, designed, and approved.
- **Performance targeting.** How KPIs are set, aligned with organizational outcomes, and tracked.
- **Monitoring and reporting.** How the agency monitors progress against plans and reports performance.

**Length guide:** 8-12 pages.

### 4.1.6 Chapter VI: Service Delivery

This is the core of your MOP. This chapter documents every procedure your agency uses to deliver its mandated services. Each service or output gets its own workflow table using the PRLS four-column format (Chapter 5).

**Required content:**

- **List of services and outputs.** A complete catalog of what your agency produces.
- **Workflow tables for each service.** Step-by-step procedures in the four-column format: step number, responsible person, action/procedure, and output/form used.
- **Turnaround time standards.** Expected processing time for each service, categorized as simple, routine, or complex.
- **Quality standards.** What constitutes an acceptable output for each service.
- **Escalation procedures.** What happens when a service cannot be delivered within the standard turnaround time.

**Length guide:** 20-40 pages (the largest chapter).

> **This chapter is where the PRLS MOP Model (Chapter 5) applies most directly.** Organize your service delivery procedures by output category, use four-column workflow tables, and follow the hierarchical approval flow: Reception, Evaluation/Delegation, Execution, Review, Approval, Delivery.

### 4.1.7 Chapter VII: Procurement and Property Management

This chapter documents procurement procedures, property management, and supply management.

**Required content:**

- **Procurement procedures.** Small value procurement, competitive bidding, alternative methods of procurement. Reference RA 9184 (Government Procurement Reform Act) and BAA 84.
- **Property management.** Receiving, recording, issuing, and disposing of government property.
- **Supply management.** Requesting, purchasing, storing, and distributing supplies.
- **Inventory procedures.** Physical inventory schedules, reconciliation, and reporting.
- **Vehicle management.** If applicable, vehicle assignment, use, maintenance, and fueling procedures.

**Length guide:** 10-15 pages.

### 4.1.8 Chapter VIII: Reporting and Accountability

This chapter documents all reporting obligations and accountability mechanisms.

**Required content:**

- **Internal reports.** Weekly, monthly, quarterly, and annual reports that divisions must submit to the agency head.
- **External reports.** Reports submitted to the Chief Minister's Office, Parliament, COA, CSC, DBM, and other oversight bodies.
- **Compliance reports.** Gender and Development (GAD), Persons with Disabilities (PWD), and other mandated compliance reports.
- **Records management.** How records are created, filed, maintained, retrieved, and disposed of.
- **Document control.** How official documents are numbered, tracked, and archived.

**Length guide:** 8-12 pages.

### 4.1.9 Chapter IX: Annexes

The Annexes chapter contains all forms, templates, checklists, and reference documents mentioned in the MOP.

**Required content:**

- **All forms referenced in Chapters I-VIII.** Each form should be labeled, numbered, and include instructions for completion.
- **Organizational chart.** Full-size version.

- **Legal references.** Relevant excerpts from BAA 13, the enabling BAA, and other governing legislation.
- **Sample completed forms.** At least one example of each major form, filled out correctly.
- **Glossary.** If not already included in Chapter I.

**Length guide:** Variable (15-50 pages depending on the number of forms).

## 4.2 Format Standards

Consistent formatting makes your MOP professional and easy to navigate. Apply these standards throughout.

### 4.2.1 Page Layout and Typography

| Element | Standard |
|---|---|
| **Paper size** | A4 (210 × 297 mm) |
| **Margins** | Top: 25mm, Bottom: 30mm, Left: 25mm, Right: 22mm |
| **Body font** | Inter, Calibri, or Arial, 11pt |
| **Heading 1 (Chapter)** | 22pt, bold, navy (#1B365D) |
| **Heading 2 (Section)** | 16pt, bold, navy |
| **Heading 3 (Subsection)** | 13pt, bold, navy |
| **Heading 4 (Sub-subsection)** | 11.5pt, bold, slate (#2C5F7C) |
| **Line spacing** | 1.15 |
| **Paragraph spacing** | 6pt after |
| **Page numbers** | Bottom center, “Page X of Y” format |

### 4.2.2 Numbering Systems

Use a hierarchical decimal numbering system:

- **Chapter:** Chapter I, Chapter II, etc. (Roman numerals for MOP chapters, to distinguish from this guidebook’s Arabic numerals)
- **Section:** 1.0, 2.0, 3.0
- **Subsection:** 1.1, 1.2, 1.3
- **Sub-subsection:** 1.1.1, 1.1.2, 1.1.3
- **Procedure steps:** 1, 2, 3 (Arabic numerals within workflow tables)

Number all forms in the Annexes: Form 1, Form 2, etc. Cross-reference forms by number throughout the MOP.

### 4.2.3 Header and Footer Requirements

Every page of the MOP (except the cover page) should include:

- **Header:** Agency name and MOP title, centered, 8pt italic
- **Footer left:** "MOP – [Agency Acronym] – [Effective Date]"
- **Footer right:** "Page X of Y"

## 4.3 Visual Aids and Diagrams

Visual aids transform dense text into scannable information. Include at least three types of visual aids in your MOP.

### 4.3.1 Workflow Diagrams

Create a workflow diagram for each major procedure. Use standard flowchart notation:

- **Start/End:** Rounded rectangle
- **Process step:** Rectangle
- **Decision:** Diamond
- **Document:** Rectangle with wavy bottom edge
- **Direction:** Arrows

Place workflow diagrams at the beginning of each procedure section, before the detailed workflow table. The diagram gives readers a quick overview; the table provides the step-by-step detail.

### 4.3.2 Organizational Charts

Include organizational charts at three levels:

1. **Agency-wide chart** in Chapter II showing all divisions and their reporting relationships
2. **Division-level charts** in Chapter VI showing the internal structure of each division
3. **Functional responsibility matrix** showing which positions are responsible for which services

### 4.3.3 Decision Trees

Use decision trees for processes that involve multiple branching paths. Decision trees are especially useful for:

- Determining which procurement method to use based on estimated cost
- Determining which approval authority applies based on transaction amount
- Routing incoming documents to the correct division based on subject matter
- Determining which leave type applies based on the employee's situation

## 4.4 Ensuring Consistency Across Chapters

Consistency is the hallmark of a professional MOP. Apply these checks before finalizing:

**Terminology consistency.** Use the same term for the same thing throughout. If you call it “Referral and Action Slip” in Chapter VI, do not call it “Action Slip” in Chapter VIII or “Routing Form” in the Annexes. Create a terminology list and enforce it.

**Cross-reference accuracy.** Every reference to a form, section, or chapter must point to the correct location. Verify each cross-reference after the final draft is assembled.

**Role title consistency.** Use official position titles from the staffing pattern. Do not alternate between “Division Chief,” “Chief of Division,” and “Division Head” for the same position.

**Numbering continuity.** Verify that no numbers are skipped or duplicated in the chapter, section, and form numbering systems.

**Format consistency.** Check that heading levels, table formats, bullet styles, and spacing are uniform throughout. A QA Specialist (Section 2.2.3) should conduct this check.

> **Quality check.** Before submitting the draft for review, the Technical Writer and QA Specialist should independently verify all cross-references, terminology, and formatting. Use the Quality Review Checklist in Chapter 7 as your guide.

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*Back to Table of Contents*

# 05

## The PRLS MOP Model

This is the most important chapter in this guidebook. It presents the MOP format used by the **Policy Research and Legal Services (PRLS)** of the Bangsamoro Parliament as the gold standard for procedural documentation. Study this chapter carefully. Use its templates. Adapt its structure for your agency.

The PRLS MOP succeeds because it is built on four principles: **output-based organization**, **four-column workflow tables**, **hierarchical approval flow**, and **standardized forms**. This chapter explains each principle in detail and provides a complete sample procedure you can use as a template.

## 5.1 Why the PRLS Format Is the Gold Standard

Most MOPs in government agencies are organized around organizational units: "Chapter III: Administrative Division," "Chapter IV: Finance Division." This approach has a fundamental weakness. It describes what each unit does, but it does not show how work flows across units to produce a specific output.

The PRLS format solves this problem. It organizes procedures around **outputs** – the tangible products the agency delivers. Each procedure traces the complete journey of an output from the moment a request is received to the moment the finished product is delivered. Every person who touches the output appears in the workflow. Every handoff is documented. Every form is specified.

This output-based approach has five advantages:

1. **Traceability.** Every procedure traces back to a specific mandated function. You can prove that every step serves a purpose.
2. **Accountability.** Every step has a named responsible person. When something goes wrong, you know exactly where.
3. **Trainability.** New staff can read the workflow table and understand their role without extensive oral explanation.
4. **Measurability.** Because each step is explicit, you can measure processing time, identify bottlenecks, and set turnaround standards.
5. **Auditability.** Auditors can verify compliance step by step. The MOP serves as the audit criterion.

# 5.2 Output-Based Organization

## 5.2.1 The Four Major Output Categories

The PRLS model organizes all agency outputs into four major categories. Every MOA can adapt these categories to its own mandate:

| Category | Description | Examples |
|---|---|---|
| **Category A: Policy and Legislative Outputs** | Documents that establish, interpret, or analyze policy | Legislative analysis briefers, policy memoranda, position papers, committee reports |
| **Category B: Administrative and Management Outputs** | Documents that manage internal operations | Personnel actions, budget requests, procurement documents, office orders |
| **Category C: Research and Information Outputs** | Documents that compile, analyze, or present information | Research papers, data compilations, comparative analyses, statistical reports |
| **Category D: Correspondence and Communication Outputs** | Documents that communicate with internal or external parties | Official correspondence, transmittal memoranda, endorsement letters, reports to oversight bodies |

For a Ministry like MBHTE, the categories might be:

| Category | MBHTE Examples |
|---|---|
| **A: Education Policy Outputs** | Curriculum guidelines, education standards, accreditation criteria |
| **B: Administrative Outputs** | Personnel actions, budget requests, procurement |
| **C: Research and Data Outputs** | Education statistics, school performance reports, needs assessments |
| **D: Service Delivery Outputs** | Scholarship certifications, school permits, equivalency credentials |

For a Commission like BWC (created by BAA 8), the categories might be:

| Category | BWC Examples |
|---|---|
| **A: Policy Advisory Outputs** | Gender policy recommendations, GAD compliance reviews |
| **B: Administrative Outputs** | Personnel actions, budget requests, procurement |
| **C: Research and Monitoring Outputs** | Gender statistics, women's rights monitoring reports |
| **D: Advocacy and Program Outputs** | Training programs, awareness campaigns, assistance referrals |

### 5.2.2 Mapping Outputs to Mandates

Every output your agency produces should trace to a specific mandate. Build a mapping table:

| Output | Mandate Source | BAA/Legal Reference |
|---|---|---|
| Legislative Analysis Briefer | Provide policy research and analysis to Parliament | BAA 13, Section [relevant section] |
| Gender Policy Review | Mainstream gender in all government programs | BAA 8, Section [relevant section] |
| Budget Preparation Report | Prepare and submit annual budget proposals | BAA 84, Section [relevant section] |

If an output cannot be traced to a mandate, question whether your agency should be producing it. If it can be traced, document the connection. This mapping feeds directly into the Mandate-to-Procedure Traceability Matrix described in Chapter 6.

## 5.3 The Four-Column Workflow Table

The heart of the PRLS MOP is the **four-column workflow table**. Every procedure is documented using this format. The table shows every step, every responsible person, every action, and every form used.

### 5.3.1 Column 1: Step Number

Simple sequential numbering: 1, 2, 3, etc. Each step represents one discrete action by one responsible person. When a different person takes over, that is a new step.

**Rules:** - One action per step - One responsible person per step - Number steps consecutively without gaps - Use sub-steps (1a, 1b) only when a single person performs multiple related actions within one handoff

### 5.3.2 Column 2: Responsible Person/Unit

State the **position title** of the person responsible for the step, not their name. MOPs survive personnel changes. Use the official title from the staffing pattern.

**Rules:** - Use position titles, not names (e.g., "Director II," not "Dr. Ahmad") - Include the division or unit in parentheses on first mention (e.g., "Staff Officer (Research Division)") - Be specific. "Staff" is too vague. "Staff Officer II, Research Division" is correct. - For steps that any staff member in a unit may perform, write "Designated Staff Officer, [Unit Name]"

### 5.3.3 Column 3: Action/Procedure

Describe the action in imperative mood. Start with a verb. Be specific enough that a new employee can follow the step without oral explanation.

**Rules:** - Start with an action verb: "Receives," "Reviews," "Prepares," "Endorses," "Approves," "Transmits" - Include specific details: form names, system names, routing destinations - State the decision criteria when the step involves a judgment call - Note what happens in alternative scenarios (e.g., "If incomplete, returns to the sender with a note specifying the missing requirements")

**Good example:** "Receives the incoming request. Logs it in the Document Tracking System with the date, sender, and subject. Attaches a Referral and Action Slip (Form 1). Forwards the request with the attached slip to the Director II within two (2) hours of receipt."

**Poor example:** “Processes the document.” (Too vague. What exactly does “processes” mean?)

### 5.3.4 Column 4: Output/Form Used

State the document, form, or output produced at this step. If no new document is produced, state “N/A” or describe the status change (e.g., “Request logged in tracking system”).

**Rules:** - Reference forms by name and number: “Referral and Action Slip (Form 1)” - Describe the output’s status: “Draft briefer,” “Reviewed briefer with annotations,” “Approved briefer with Director’s signature” - Include the disposition of the document: where it goes next

## 5.4 Hierarchical Approval Flow

The PRLS model follows a six-stage approval flow. Every output moves through these stages, though simpler outputs may compress or skip stages. The flow ensures that work is received systematically, assigned to the right person, executed competently, reviewed for quality, approved by authority, and delivered to the client.

### 5.4.1 Reception Stage

**Purpose:** Receive incoming requests or tasks and log them for tracking.

**Typical responsible person:** Administrative Officer, Records Officer, or Designated Receiving Staff

**Standard actions:** 1. Receive the document or request 2. Check completeness of submitted documents 3. Log in the document tracking system (date, time, sender, subject, reference number) 4. Attach a Referral and Action Slip (Form 1) 5. Forward to the Director or Division Chief within a specified time (typically two hours)

**Key principle:** Nothing enters the workflow without being logged. Every document receives a tracking number. Every request is acknowledged.

> **Why this matters.** Without a reception stage, documents arrive at staff desks without tracking. They can be lost, delayed, or forgotten. The reception stage creates a paper trail from the first moment of contact.

### 5.4.2 Evaluation and Delegation Stage

**Purpose:** The director or division chief evaluates the request and assigns it to the appropriate staff member.

**Typical responsible person:** Director II, Division Chief, or Section Head

**Standard actions:** 1. Receive the request from the receiving staff 2. Review the Referral and Action Slip 3. Evaluate the nature, complexity, and urgency of the request 4. Assign the request to the appropriate staff officer or section 5. Write specific instructions on the Action Slip (e.g., “Prepare a legislative analysis briefer on this bill. Deadline: 5 working days.”) 6. Return the request with the annotated Action Slip to the assigned staff through proper channels

**Key principle:** The supervisor does not just pass the document along. They add value by categorizing, prioritizing, and providing specific instructions. The Action Slip becomes a mini-terms-of-reference for the assignment.

### 5.4.3 Execution Stage

**Purpose:** The assigned staff member performs the substantive work: research, analysis, drafting, computation, or other task-specific actions.

**Typical responsible person:** Staff Officer, Analyst, Technical Staff

**Standard actions:** 1. Receive the assignment with the annotated Action Slip 2. Review the request and the Director's instructions 3. Perform the required work (research, analysis, drafting, computation) 4. Prepare the draft output following format standards 5. Conduct a self-review of the draft output 6. Submit the draft output to the immediate supervisor (Section Head or Chief of Division) with a transmittal note

**Key principle:** The staff officer works within the scope defined by the Director's instructions. If the scope needs to change (e.g., the research reveals that the request requires a different type of analysis), the staff officer consults the Director before proceeding.

### 5.4.4 Review Stage

**Purpose:** The supervisor reviews the draft output for accuracy, completeness, and quality before forwarding to the approving authority.

**Typical responsible person:** Chief of Division, Section Head, or Senior Staff

**Standard actions:** 1. Receive the draft output from the staff officer 2. Review for accuracy, completeness, and compliance with standards 3. Check for errors in facts, analysis, computation, or formatting 4. Annotate the draft with corrections or comments 5. If major revisions are needed, return to the staff officer with specific instructions 6. If minor revisions are needed, annotate and return for quick correction 7. If satisfactory, endorse to the Director for approval

**Key principle:** The review stage is a quality gate. Nothing reaches the approving authority without passing through at least one quality review. This protects both the staff officer (whose work is improved) and the Director (who receives polished outputs).

### 5.4.5 Approval Stage

**Purpose:** The approving authority reviews the endorsed output and provides final approval.

**Typical responsible person:** Director II, Executive Director, or Agency Head

**Standard actions:** 1. Receive the endorsed output from the reviewing officer 2. Review for policy alignment, strategic fit, and overall quality 3. If approved, sign the output and any accompanying transmittal documents 4. If revisions needed, return with specific instructions 5. Direct the mode and timing of delivery

**Key principle:** The approving authority focuses on substance and policy, not on formatting or computation. Those issues should have been caught at the Review Stage. If the approving authority is frequently sending outputs back for basic errors, the Review Stage needs strengthening.

### 5.4.6 Delivery Stage

**Purpose:** Deliver the approved output to the requesting party and close the tracking record.

**Typical responsible person:** Administrative Officer, Records Officer, or Designated Delivery Staff

**Standard actions:** 1. Receive the approved output from the Director 2. Prepare the Transmittal Memorandum (Form 2) if the output is being sent to an external party 3. Make copies for file retention 4. Deliver the output to the requesting party (in person, by official mail, or electronically) 5. Obtain acknowledgment of receipt (signature on receiving copy or electronic confirmation) 6. Update the Document Tracking System with the completion date and disposition 7. File the office copy with all attachments

**Key principle:** The delivery stage closes the loop. The tracking system shows the complete lifecycle: date received, date assigned, date completed, date delivered. This data feeds your performance metrics (Chapter 7).

## 5.5 Standardized Forms

The PRLS MOP uses four standard forms that every MOA should adapt and adopt.

### 5.5.1 Referral and Action Slips

The **Referral and Action Slip** is the routing control document. It is attached to every incoming request and accompanies the document throughout its lifecycle.

**Contents of the Referral and Action Slip:**

| Field | Description |
|---|---|
| **Reference Number** | Unique tracking number (format: [Agency]-[Year]-[Sequential Number]) |
| **Date Received** | Date and time the document was received |
| **Received From** | Sender's name, position, and agency |
| **Subject** | Brief description of the request |
| **Referred To** | Name and position of the person to whom the request is assigned |
| **Action Required** | Specific instructions from the Director (e.g., "For research and analysis," "For comment and recommendation," "For appropriate action") |
| **Deadline** | Date by which the action must be completed |
| **Priority** | Urgent, Routine, or For Information |
| **Remarks** | Additional instructions or context |
| **Signature of Referring Officer** | Director or Division Chief's signature |
| **Date of Action Completion** | Filled in when the assigned person completes the task |
| **Action Taken** | Brief description of what was done |

## 5.5.2 Transmittal Memoranda

The **Transmittal Memorandum** accompanies every output delivered to an external party. It provides context, identifies the output, and creates a record of delivery.

**Standard format:**

```
TRANSMITTAL MEMORANDUM

TO:         [Recipient's Name, Position, Agency]
FROM:       [Sender's Name, Position, Agency]
DATE:       [Date]
SUBJECT:    [Brief Description of the Output Being Transmitted]

1. Transmitted herewith is [description of the output], prepared in
   response to [reference to the original request, including date and
   reference number].

2. [Brief summary of the output's key findings or content, if applicable.]

3. For your [information / review and comment / appropriate action].

[Signature]
[Name]
[Position]
```

## 5.5.3 Routing Slips

The **Routing Slip** tracks the document's movement within the office. Unlike the Referral and Action Slip (which assigns work), the Routing Slip records each handoff.

**Contents:**

| Column | Description |
|---|---|
| **Date/Time** | When the document was received by this person |
| **Received By** | Name and position |
| **Action Taken** | What was done with the document |
| **Forwarded To** | Name and position of the next person |
| **Date/Time Forwarded** | When the document was sent to the next person |

| Column | Description |
|---|---|
| **Remarks** | Any notes |

## 5.5.4 Tracking Logs

The **Tracking Log** is the master register of all documents received and processed by the office. It provides a bird's-eye view of all active and completed transactions.

**Contents:**

| Column | Description |
|---|---|
| **Reference Number** | Unique tracking number |
| **Date Received** | When the document arrived |
| **Source** | Who sent it |
| **Subject** | What it is about |
| **Assigned To** | Who is working on it |
| **Deadline** | When it is due |
| **Status** | Pending, In Progress, For Review, For Approval, Completed, Delivered |
| **Date Completed** | When the output was finished |
| **Date Delivered** | When it was sent to the requestor |
| **Remarks** | Notes on delays, returns, or special instructions |

## 5.6 Complete Sample Procedure: Producing a Legislative Analysis Briefer

This section presents a complete procedure in the PRLS format. Use it as a template for documenting procedures in your own MOP. This example shows the procedure for producing a Legislative Analysis Briefer in response to a bill referred to the agency for review.

**Output:** Legislative Analysis Briefer **Category:** A (Policy and Legislative Outputs) **Legal basis:** BAA 13 (mandate to provide policy research and analysis) **Standard turnaround time:** 5 working days (routine), 3 working days (urgent)

### Procedure: Production of a Legislative Analysis Briefer

| Step | Responsible Person | Action/Procedure | Output/Form Used |
|---|---|---|---|
| **RECEPTION** | | | |
| 1 | Administrative Officer (Admin Unit) | Receives the referral letter or committee memorandum requesting analysis of a filed bill. Checks completeness: (a) referral letter, (b) copy of the bill, (c) committee resolution if applicable. Logs the request in the Document Tracking System with date, time, sender, subject, and reference number. Assigns a tracking reference number. | Document Tracking Log (Form 4) updated. Entry created. |
| 2 | Administrative Officer (Admin Unit) | Attaches a Referral and Action Slip (Form 1) to the request package. Marks the priority level (Urgent or Routine). Forwards the complete package to the Director II within two (2) hours of receipt. | Referral and Action Slip (Form 1) attached. Package forwarded. |
| **EVALUATION AND DELEGATION** | | | |

| Step | Responsible Person | Action/Procedure | Output/Form Used |
|---|---|---|---|
| 3 | Director II | Receives the request package from the Administrative Officer. Reviews the bill and referral letter. Evaluates the subject matter, complexity, and urgency. Identifies the appropriate Chief of Division based on subject matter expertise. Writes specific instructions on the Referral and Action Slip: type of analysis required, specific issues to address, deadline, and any special considerations. Signs the Referral and Action Slip. | Referral and Action Slip (Form 1) annotated with instructions and signed by Director II. |
| 4 | Director II | Forwards the annotated package to the designated Chief of Division. | Package forwarded to Chief of Division. |
| **DELEGATION (DIVISION LEVEL)** | | | |
| 5 | Chief of Division (assigned division) | Receives the package from the Director II. Reviews the Director's instructions on the Referral and Action Slip. Assigns the task to the appropriate Staff Officer based on subject matter expertise and current workload. Adds division-level instructions if needed. | Assignment communicated to Staff Officer. |
| **EXECUTION** | | | |
| 6 | Staff Officer (assigned) | Receives the assignment with the bill, referral letter, and annotated Referral and Action Slip. Reviews the bill and the Director's instructions. Identifies the research requirements. | Research plan noted. |
| 7 | Staff Officer (assigned) | Conducts research and analysis: (a) reviews the bill section by section, (b) identifies related laws, BAAs, and issuances, (c) checks compliance with BOL and BAA 13, (d) assesses policy implications, | Draft Legislative Analysis Briefer prepared. |

| Step | Responsible Person | Action/Procedure | Output/Form Used |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | (e) identifies implementation requirements, (f) reviews relevant BDP 2023-2028 goals, (g) identifies stakeholder impact. Prepares the draft Legislative Analysis Briefer using the standard template (Form 5). | |
| 8 | Staff Officer (assigned) | Conducts a self-review of the draft: checks factual accuracy, completeness, consistency, and formatting. Corrects any errors found. | Self-reviewed draft. |
| 9 | Staff Officer (assigned) | Submits the draft Legislative Analysis Briefer to the Chief of Division with a brief transmittal note summarizing key findings and any issues requiring guidance. | Draft briefer submitted with transmittal note. |
| **REVIEW** | | | |
| 10 | Chief of Division | Receives the draft briefer from the Staff Officer. Reviews for: (a) accuracy of legal citations, (b) completeness of analysis, (c) soundness of policy assessment, (d) compliance with format standards, (e) clarity of writing. Annotates the draft with corrections or comments. | Reviewed draft with annotations. |
| 11 | Chief of Division | If major revisions are needed: returns the draft to the Staff Officer with specific written instructions for revision. Staff Officer revises and resubmits (return to Step 8). If satisfactory or requiring only minor edits: makes minor corrections and prepares an endorsement note to the Director II. | Endorsed draft with endorsement note, or returned draft with revision instructions. |
| **APPROVAL** | | | |

| Step | Responsible Person | Action/Procedure | Output/Form Used |
|---|---|---|---|
| 12 | Director II | Receives the endorsed draft from the Chief of Division. Reviews for: (a) policy alignment, (b) strategic accuracy, (c) completeness of response to the original request, (d) overall quality. | Reviewed draft. |
| 13 | Director II | If revisions are needed: returns to the Chief of Division with instructions (return to Step 10). If approved: signs the Legislative Analysis Briefer. Directs the mode of transmittal (e.g., "Transmit to the Committee Chairperson via Transmittal Memorandum"). | Approved and signed Legislative Analysis Briefer. |
| **DELIVERY** | | | |
| 14 | Administrative Officer (Admin Unit) | Receives the approved briefer from the Director II. Prepares the Transmittal Memorandum (Form 2) addressed to the requesting party. Attaches the signed briefer. Makes three (3) copies: (a) original for the requesting party, (b) file copy, (c) copy for the assigned Staff Officer's reference. | Transmittal Memorandum (Form 2) prepared. Copies made. |
| 15 | Administrative Officer (Admin Unit) | Delivers the original briefer with the Transmittal Memorandum to the requesting party. Obtains acknowledgment of receipt (signature on receiving copy or electronic confirmation). Updates the Document Tracking System with the completion date, delivery date, and disposition. Files the office copy with all attachments (original request, Referral and Action Slip, draft with annotations, and receiving copy). | Document Tracking Log (Form 4) updated. File closed. |

## Summary of Forms Used

| Form | Name | Used At |
|---|---|---|
| Form 1 | Referral and Action Slip | Steps 2, 3, 5, 6 |
| Form 2 | Transmittal Memorandum | Step 14 |
| Form 4 | Document Tracking Log | Steps 1, 15 |
| Form 5 | Legislative Analysis Briefer Template | Step 7 |

## Turnaround Time Standard

| Complexity | Total Calendar Days | Active Working Days | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Routine** (standard bill, no novel issues) | 5 working days | 3 days active work | Standard timeline |
| **Urgent** (floor deliberation imminent) | 3 working days | 2 days active work | Director escalation required |
| **Complex** (novel legal issues, multi-agency impact) | 10 working days | 5-7 days active work | Director may assign multiple staff |

## 5.7 Adapting the PRLS Model for Any MOA

The PRLS model was designed for a legislative research office, but its principles apply to any MOA. Here is how to adapt it:

**Step 1: Identify your outputs.** List every tangible product your agency delivers. Group them into four categories (adapt the category names to fit your mandate).

**Step 2: Map each output to a mandate.** Trace each output to a specific function defined in BAA 13 or your enabling BAA (see Chapter 6).

**Step 3: Document the workflow.** For each output, trace the complete lifecycle from reception to delivery. Identify every person who touches the output. Document every handoff.

**Step 4: Build the four-column table.** Use the format shown in Section 5.6. One step per row. One responsible person per step. Start with an action verb. Specify forms by name and number.

**Step 5: Follow the six-stage flow.** Structure every procedure around Reception, Evaluation/Delegation, Execution, Review, Approval, and Delivery. Simple procedures may compress stages (e.g., the Director both reviews and approves in a single step). Complex procedures may expand stages (e.g., multiple review levels before approval).

**Step 6: Create your forms.** Adapt the four standard forms (Referral and Action Slip, Transmittal Memorandum, Routing Slip, Tracking Log) to your agency's needs. Add agency-specific forms for specialized outputs.

**Step 7: Set turnaround standards.** For each output, define turnaround times for routine, urgent, and complex requests (see Chapter 7).

**Step 8: Test the procedure.** Before finalizing, walk through the procedure with the people who will execute it. Ask: "Can you follow these steps as written? Is anything missing? Is anything unnecessary?" Revise based on their feedback.

> **The test of a good MOP procedure.** A new employee, reading the workflow table for the first time, should be able to execute the procedure correctly without asking anyone for clarification. If they need to ask, the procedure is not detailed enough.

*Back to Table of Contents*

# 06

## Grounding MOPs in Legal Mandates

A MOP without a legal foundation is a suggestion, not a standard. Every procedure in your MOP must trace to a specific mandate defined in law. This chapter shows you how to extract mandates from BAA 13 and related legislation, cross-reference with enabling BAAs, and build a traceability matrix that proves every procedure serves a legally defined purpose.

## 6.1 The Central Role of BAA 13

**Bangsamoro Autonomy Act No. 13**, the **Bangsamoro Administrative Code**, is the foundational law for all BARMM Ministries, Offices, and Agencies. It defines the organizational framework of the Bangsamoro Government's executive branch. Every MOP starts here.

### 6.1.1 How BAA 13 Defines MOA Structure

BAA 13 establishes the following for each Ministry:

- **Creation.** The legal basis for the Ministry's existence.
- **Mandate.** The overarching purpose the Ministry serves.
- **Powers and functions.** The specific activities the Ministry is authorized and required to perform.
- **Organizational structure.** The divisions, offices, and units within the Ministry.
- **Key positions.** The Minister, Undersecretary, Assistant Secretary, and Division Chiefs.
- **Relationships.** How the Ministry relates to other government bodies, both within BARMM and with national agencies.

Your MOP's organizational structure (Chapter II) must be consistent with BAA 13. Your service delivery procedures (Chapter VI) must serve the functions listed in BAA 13. Your reporting obligations (Chapter VIII) must satisfy the accountability requirements BAA 13 imposes.

### 6.1.2 Extracting Mandate and Functions

Follow this five-step process to extract your agency's mandate and functions from BAA 13:

**Step 1: Locate your agency in BAA 13.** Find the specific title, chapter, or section of BAA 13 that addresses your Ministry or agency. Read every provision carefully.

**Step 2: List all mandated functions.** Copy each function verbatim from BAA 13. Number them sequentially. This becomes your **master function list**.

**Step 3: Categorize each function.** Classify each function into one of four categories:

| Category | Description | Example |
|---|---|---|
| **Regulatory** | Functions that regulate, supervise, or enforce | "Regulate and supervise all cooperatives in the Bangsamoro" |
| **Service delivery** | Functions that deliver services to citizens or other agencies | "Provide scholarship programs for Bangsamoro students" |
| **Policy and advisory** | Functions that develop policy or provide advice | "Formulate policies on education development" |
| **Administrative** | Functions that manage internal operations | "Manage the personnel of the Ministry" |

**Step 4: Map functions to outputs.** For each mandated function, identify the specific outputs your agency produces to fulfill that function. A single function may require multiple outputs.

**Step 5: Map outputs to procedures.** For each output, document the procedure that produces it. This is where your MOP's workflow tables connect to BAA 13.

The result is a clear chain: **BAA 13 mandate** leads to **function** leads to **output** leads to **procedure** leads to **workflow table**.

## 6.2 Cross-Referencing Enabling BAAs

Many BARMM agencies were created by specific BAAs that supplement BAA 13 with detailed mandates, functions, and organizational provisions. Your MOP must reference both BAA 13 (general administrative framework) and your enabling BAA (specific agency mandate).

### 6.2.1 BAA 8: Bangsamoro Women Commission

**BAA 8** created the **Bangsamoro Women Commission (BWC)**. It defines the BWC's mandate to mainstream gender in all government programs, protect women's rights, and promote women's participation in governance.

**MOP implications:** - Service delivery procedures must include gender analysis procedures - Research outputs must include gender-disaggregated data collection - Policy advisory outputs must include Gender and Development (GAD) compliance reviews - Coordination procedures must define relationships with all MOAs on gender mainstreaming

### 6.2.2 BAA 9: Bangsamoro Human Rights Commission

**BAA 9** created the **Bangsamoro Human Rights Commission (BHRC)**. It defines the BHRC's mandate to investigate human rights violations, provide legal assistance, and promote human rights awareness.

**MOP implications:** - Investigation procedures must define intake, assessment, investigation, and resolution stages - Case management procedures must include documentation, evidence handling, and confidentiality protocols - Reporting procedures must define how findings are communicated to the Parliament and the public - Coordination procedures must define relationships with national human rights bodies

### 6.2.3 BAA 10: Bangsamoro Youth Commission

**BAA 10** created the **Bangsamoro Youth Commission (BYC)**. It defines the BYC's mandate to promote youth development, coordinate youth programs, and represent youth interests in governance.

**MOP implications:** - Program delivery procedures must cover youth development programs and activities - Coordination procedures must define relationships with youth organizations and LGUs - Research outputs must include youth situation analyses and needs assessments - Advocacy procedures must define how youth policy recommendations are developed and submitted

### 6.2.4 BAA 17: Bangsamoro Civil Service Code

**BAA 17** governs human resources management across all BARMM agencies. Every MOP's Chapter III (Human Resource Management) must comply with BAA 17.

**MOP implications:** - Recruitment procedures must follow BAA 17 merit-based selection requirements - Appointment procedures must comply with BAA 17 classification and qualification standards - Performance evaluation procedures must align with BAA 17 performance management provisions - Discipline procedures must follow BAA 17 administrative disciplinary provisions - Leave and benefits procedures must comply with BAA 17 entitlements

### 6.2.5 BAA 18: Bangsamoro Education Code

**BAA 18** defines the mandate and functions of the **Ministry of Basic, Higher, and Technical Education (MBHTE)**. It establishes the education system's structure, standards, and delivery mechanisms.

**MOP implications for MBHTE:** - Curriculum development procedures must follow BAA 18 education standards - School accreditation procedures must comply with BAA 18 quality requirements - Scholarship procedures must align with BAA 18 access provisions - Teacher development procedures must follow BAA 18 professional standards - Education data procedures must satisfy BAA 18 reporting requirements

### 6.2.6 BAA 35: Bangsamoro Electoral Code

**BAA 35** governs electoral processes in the BARMM. It defines the procedures for voter registration, candidate filing, election administration, and results canvassing.

**MOP implications for election administration:** - Voter registration procedures must follow BAA 35 registration requirements - Election operations procedures must comply with BAA 35 administration standards - Results management procedures must follow BAA 35 canvassing and proclamation rules - Complaint resolution procedures must align with BAA 35 adjudication provisions

### 6.2.7 BAA 82: Bangsamoro Labor Code

**BAA 82** defines labor standards, employment procedures, and worker protections in the BARMM.

**MOP implications:** - Labor inspection procedures must follow BAA 82 enforcement provisions - Employment regulation procedures must comply with BAA 82 standards - Dispute resolution procedures must align with BAA 82 mediation and adjudication mechanisms - Worker registration and certification procedures must follow BAA 82 requirements

### 6.2.8 BAA 84: Budget System Act

**BAA 84** governs budget preparation, execution, and accountability for all BARMM agencies. Every MOP's Chapter IV (Financial Management) must comply with BAA 84.

**MOP implications:** - Budget preparation procedures must follow BAA 84 budget call and submission requirements - Budget execution procedures must comply with BAA 84 allotment and obligation rules - Disbursement procedures must follow BAA 84 payment processing standards - Financial reporting procedures must satisfy BAA 84 accountability requirements - Program budgeting procedures must align with BAA 84 performance-based budgeting provisions

## 6.3 Ensuring BOL Compliance

Your MOP operates within the constitutional framework established by **Republic Act No. 11054**, the Bangsamoro Organic Law. While BAA 13 and enabling BAAs define specific mandates, the BOL defines the boundaries of Bangsamoro Government authority.

### 6.3.1 Aligning with BOL Article V Powers

BOL Article V, Section 2 enumerates the powers of the Bangsamoro Government. Your agency's mandate must fall within these enumerated powers or within the general welfare clause of Article V, Section 3. If a procedure in your MOP implements a function that exceeds Bangsamoro Government authority, the procedure is legally vulnerable.

**Checklist for BOL compliance:** - Does the procedure implement a function within the enumerated powers? - If not enumerated, does the procedure fall within the general welfare clause? - Does the procedure affect areas reserved to Congress (residual powers)? - Does the procedure comply with the constitutional rights provisions of the BOL? - Does the procedure respect the relationship between BARMM and national government agencies?

### 6.3.2 Respecting Constitutional Boundaries

The BOL exists within the framework of the 1987 Philippine Constitution. Your MOP cannot authorize procedures that violate constitutional provisions. Key boundaries:

- **Due process.** Every regulatory or enforcement procedure must provide notice and an opportunity to be heard.
- **Equal protection.** Procedures must apply uniformly to similarly situated persons.
- **Right to information.** Procedures must support transparency and public access to non-confidential government records.
- **Fiscal autonomy.** Financial procedures must respect the fiscal autonomy provisions of the BOL while complying with national accountability standards.

## 6.4 The Mandate-to-Procedure Traceability Matrix

The **Mandate-to-Procedure Traceability Matrix** is the document that proves every procedure in your MOP is legally grounded. Build one matrix that covers your entire MOP.

| No. | Legal Source | Mandate/ Function | Output | MOP Procedure | MOP Location |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | BAA 13, Sec. ☑ | Provide policy research and analysis | Legislative Analysis Briefer | Procedure for Producing a Legislative Analysis Briefer | Ch. VI, Sec. 6.1 |
| 2 | BAA 13, Sec. [Y] | Manage personnel affairs | Appointment papers | Procedure for Processing Appointments | Ch. III, Sec. 3.2 |
| 3 | BAA 84, Sec. [Z] | Prepare annual budget | Budget proposal | Procedure for Budget Preparation | Ch. IV, Sec. 4.1 |
| 4 | BAA 8, Sec. [W] | Mainstream gender in all programs | GAD compliance review | Procedure for Gender Compliance Review | Ch. VI, Sec. 6.5 |
| 5 | BAA 17, Sec. [V] | Evaluate employee performance | Performance evaluation form | Procedure for Performance Evaluation | Ch. III, Sec. 3.5 |

### How to use this matrix:

1. **During drafting.** Ensure every procedure maps to a mandate. If a procedure has no legal basis, question whether it belongs in the MOP.
2. **During review.** Reviewers check the matrix to verify legal grounding. The Legal Expert (Section 2.2.5) is responsible for this review.
3. **During audits.** Present the matrix to auditors as evidence that your agency's operations are legally authorized.
4. **During updates.** When new legislation is enacted, check the matrix to identify affected procedures.

## 6.5 Keeping MOPs Current with Legislative Changes

The Bangsamoro Parliament continues to enact new BAAs. Each new law may affect your MOP. Build a process for staying current.

**Step 1: Monitor legislation.** Designate a staff member to track new BAAs and executive orders. The Bills and Index Division of the Parliament publishes enacted BAAs. Subscribe to updates.

**Step 2: Assess impact.** For each new BAA, review the Mandate-to-Procedure Traceability Matrix. Determine whether the new law creates new mandates, modifies existing mandates, or repeals mandates that your MOP currently implements.

**Step 3: Initiate amendments.** If the new law affects your MOP, initiate the amendment process described in Chapter 9. Route the amendment through the same review and approval process as the original MOP.

**Step 4: Communicate changes.** Notify all staff of MOP amendments. Distribute updated pages or sections. Conduct briefings on new procedures. Update the version number and change log.

**Step 5: Archive superseded versions.** Keep copies of all previous MOP versions. Auditors may need to verify which procedures were in effect during a specific period.

> **Practical tip.** Schedule a quarterly check of new legislation against your Mandate-to-Procedure Traceability Matrix. This 30-minute review prevents your MOP from falling out of alignment with the legal framework. Assign this responsibility to your Legal Expert (Section 2.2.5) or a designated compliance officer.

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*Back to Table of Contents*

# 07

# Quality Standards and Performance Metrics

Most existing MOPs in BARMM agencies describe procedures but say nothing about quality. They tell staff how to produce an output but not what a good output looks like. They specify who approves a document but not the criteria for approval. This chapter fills that gap.

Quality standards and performance metrics transform your MOP from a process document into a performance management tool. They give staff clear targets, give supervisors objective evaluation criteria, and give clients predictable service expectations.

## 7.1 Why Quality Criteria Matter in MOPs

Without quality criteria, reviewers at the Review Stage (Section 5.4.4) and Approval Stage (Section 5.4.5) rely on personal judgment. One Division Chief may consider a briefer acceptable if it covers the basic facts. Another may require a comprehensive policy analysis. Staff officers cannot aim at a target they cannot see.

Quality criteria solve four problems:

**1. Subjectivity in review.** When the MOP says "Review for quality," quality means whatever the reviewer thinks it means on that day. When the MOP says "Verify that the briefer includes: (a) bill summary, (b) legal basis analysis, (c) impact assessment, (d) alignment with BDP 2023-2028, and (e) recommendation," the review is objective and verifiable.

**2. Inconsistent output quality.** Without criteria, output quality varies with the staff officer's experience and the reviewer's attention. Quality criteria establish a floor that every output must meet.

**3. Inefficient revision cycles.** When staff do not know the quality standard, they submit drafts that are returned for multiple rounds of revision. Each round costs time. Clear criteria reduce revision cycles because staff know what is expected from the start.

**4. Unmeasurable performance.** You cannot improve what you cannot measure. Quality criteria create measurable standards against which you can track improvement over time.

## 7.2 Output Quality Criteria by Type

Define quality criteria for each of the four output categories identified in Chapter 5. Below are examples. Adapt them to your agency's specific outputs.

### 7.2.1 Policy Outputs (Memoranda, Directives, Guidelines)

Every policy output must meet these minimum criteria:

| Criterion | Standard |
|---|---|
| **Legal basis** | Cites the specific BAA, BOL provision, or executive order that authorizes the policy |
| **Scope** | Clearly states who the policy applies to and what it covers |
| **Definitions** | Defines all technical or specialized terms |
| **Provisions** | States obligations, prohibitions, and entitlements in specific, measurable terms |
| **Implementation mechanism** | Names the responsible implementing unit or person |
| **Effectivity** | States when the policy takes effect |
| **Format** | Follows the agency's standard memorandum or directive format |
| **Review** | Reviewed by the Legal Expert for legal soundness before submission to the approving authority |

### 7.2.2 Service Delivery Outputs (Certifications, Permits, Approvals)

Every service delivery output must meet these minimum criteria:

| Criterion | Standard |
|---|---|
| **Completeness** | All required fields are filled in. No blanks where information is required. |
| **Accuracy** | All information matches source documents. Names, dates, and reference numbers are verified. |

| Criterion | Standard |
|---|---|
| **Authority** | Signed by the authorized signatory. Signature matches the delegation of authority. |
| **Timeliness** | Completed within the standard turnaround time for that output type. |
| **Format** | Uses the official form or template. No unofficial modifications. |
| **Supporting documents** | All required attachments are present and properly organized. |
| **Distribution** | Copies distributed to all required recipients. File copy retained. |

### 7.2.3 Research and Analysis Outputs (Briefers, Reports, Studies)

Every research and analysis output must meet these minimum criteria:

| Criterion | Standard |
|---|---|
| **Responsiveness** | Directly addresses the question or request that prompted the research |
| **Factual accuracy** | All facts, statistics, and citations are verified against primary sources |
| **Legal accuracy** | All legal references cite the correct law, section, and provision |
| **Analytical depth** | Identifies implications, not just facts. Answers “so what?” for every finding. |
| **Balance** | Presents multiple perspectives on contested issues. Notes opposing arguments. |
| **Recommendation** | Provides clear, actionable recommendations supported by the analysis |
| **Sources** | Lists all sources consulted. Distinguishes primary from secondary sources. |
| **Format** | Follows the agency’s standard briefer or report template |

### 7.2.4 Administrative Outputs (Correspondence, Records, Filings)

Every administrative output must meet these minimum criteria:

| Criterion | Standard |
|---|---|
| **Addressing** | Correct recipient name, title, and agency |
| **Reference** | Cites the document, request, or correspondence being responded to |
| **Clarity** | States the purpose in the first paragraph. Uses simple, direct language. |
| **Completeness** | Includes all necessary attachments and enclosures |
| **Format** | Follows the agency's standard correspondence format |
| **Filing** | File copy made and filed in the correct folder within one working day of dispatch |

## 7.3 Turnaround Time Standards

Turnaround time is the most visible quality metric. Citizens, oversight bodies, and other agencies judge your efficiency by how fast you respond. Set realistic turnaround standards for every output.

### 7.3.1 Setting Realistic Timelines

Base your turnaround standards on actual processing data, not aspirations. If your time and motion study (Section 3.3.2) shows that a routine briefer takes four days of active work plus two days of wait time, setting a one-day turnaround is not a quality standard – it is a fantasy.

**Method for setting turnaround times:**

1. Measure actual processing time for at least ten instances of the same output
2. Calculate the average and the range (fastest and slowest)
3. Set the standard at the average or slightly below (a modest stretch target)
4. Review the standard after six months and adjust based on actual performance

### 7.3.2 Simple, Routine, and Complex Categorization

Classify every output into three complexity levels:

| Level | Description | Typical Turnaround |
|---|---|---|
| **Simple** | Requires minimal research or analysis. Uses a standard template. One reviewer sufficient. | 1-2 working days |
| **Routine** | Requires moderate research or analysis. May require coordination with one other unit. Standard review process. | 3-5 working days |
| **Complex** | Requires extensive research, analysis, or consultation. Involves multiple units or external agencies. May require multiple review levels. | 6-15 working days |

Document the criteria for each level in your MOP. When a request arrives, the Director at the Evaluation and Delegation Stage (Section 5.4.2) classifies it and sets the deadline accordingly.

### 7.3.3 Escalation Protocols for Delays

When processing exceeds the standard turnaround time, escalation protocols activate. Define three escalation levels:

**Level 1: Near deadline.** When the output is within one day of its deadline and is not yet at the Review Stage, the assigned staff officer notifies the Chief of Division. The Chief assesses the situation and provides additional support if needed.

**Level 2: At deadline.** When the deadline arrives and the output is not complete, the Chief of Division notifies the Director II. The Director decides whether to extend the deadline, reassign the task, or allocate additional resources.

**Level 3: Past deadline.** When the output exceeds the deadline by more than two working days, the Director II notifies the agency head. A root cause analysis is conducted. Systemic issues are referred to the MOP review process for procedural correction.

## 7.4 Key Performance Indicators for MOP Effectiveness

KPIs transform your MOP from a static document into a dynamic performance management tool. Track these four categories of KPIs.

### 7.4.1 Process Efficiency KPIs

| KPI | Formula | Target |
|---|---|---|
| **Average processing time** | Total processing time / Number of outputs | At or below turnaround standard |
| **On-time completion rate** | (Outputs completed on time / Total outputs) x 100 | 90% or higher |
| **Active-to-wait time ratio** | Active working time / Total processing time | 50% or higher |
| **Revision cycle rate** | (Outputs returned for revision / Total outputs) x 100 | 20% or lower |
| **Bottleneck frequency** | Number of times a specific step causes delays | Declining trend |

### 7.4.2 Output Quality KPIs

| KPI | Formula | Target |
|---|---|---|
| **Error rate** | (Outputs with errors / Total outputs) x 100 | 5% or lower |
| **Compliance rate** | (Outputs meeting all quality criteria / Total outputs) x 100 | 95% or higher |
| **Completeness rate** | (Outputs requiring no supplementary information / Total) x 100 | 90% or higher |
| **Approval-on-first-submission rate** | (Outputs approved without revision / Total outputs) x 100 | 70% or higher |

### 7.4.3 Compliance KPIs

| KPI | Formula | Target |
|---|---|---|
| **Form usage compliance** | (Transactions using prescribed forms / Total transactions) x 100 | 100% |
| **Routing compliance** | (Documents following prescribed routing / Total documents) x 100 | 95% or higher |
| **Filing compliance** | (Documents filed within one working day / Total documents) x 100 | 95% or higher |
| **Audit observation rate** | Number of MOP-related audit findings per period | Declining trend |

### 7.4.4 Client Satisfaction KPIs

| KPI | Measurement Method | Target |
|---|---|---|
| **Client satisfaction score** | Post-service survey (1-5 scale) | 4.0 or higher |
| **Complaint rate** | (Formal complaints / Total transactions) x 100 | 2% or lower |
| **Repeat request rate** | (Requests requiring re-submission / Total requests) x 100 | 5% or lower |
| **Response acknowledgment time** | Time from receipt to acknowledgment of the request | Within 2 hours |

## 7.5 Performance Monitoring Systems

Measuring KPIs requires systems. These need not be complex. Start with manual tools and upgrade to digital systems as capacity grows.

### 7.5.1 Manual Tracking Tools

For agencies without information systems, track performance using:

- **Document Tracking Log (Form 4).** The tracking log described in Section 5.5.4 captures dates received, assigned, completed, and delivered. These dates calculate processing time.
- **Monthly tally sheets.** At month-end, count total outputs, on-time completions, returned drafts, and complaints. Record on a simple tally sheet.
- **Quarterly performance dashboard.** Compile monthly data into a one-page dashboard showing trend lines for each KPI. Post the dashboard in a visible location.

### 7.5.2 Digital Monitoring Options

As your agency's capacity grows, consider these digital tools:

- **Spreadsheet tracking.** A shared spreadsheet (Google Sheets or Microsoft Excel) replicating the Document Tracking Log with automatic date calculations.
- **Project management tools.** Free tools like Trello or Notion can track document workflows with status columns, deadlines, and assignment fields.
- **Custom database.** For agencies with IT support, a simple database application can automate tracking, generate reports, and send deadline reminders.

> **Start simple.** Do not let the absence of digital tools prevent you from monitoring performance. A paper tracking log is infinitely better than no tracking at all. Upgrade incrementally.

### 7.5.3 Periodic Performance Reviews

Schedule three types of performance reviews:

**Weekly huddles (15 minutes).** The Division Chief reviews the tracking log with staff. Identify outputs that are behind schedule. Discuss bottlenecks. Adjust assignments if needed.

**Monthly performance reviews (1 hour).** The Director reviews KPIs for the month. Compare against targets. Identify trends. Recognize high performers. Address recurring issues.

**Quarterly MOP effectiveness reviews (half day).** The MOP Development Team (or its successor) reviews aggregate KPIs, user feedback, and audit findings. Recommend MOP amendments if procedures are consistently producing below-standard results.

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*Back to Table of Contents*

# 08

## Review, Approval, and Implementation

Your draft MOP is complete. The procedures are documented. The workflow tables are built. The forms are designed. Now you must validate the MOP through review, secure approval from the appropriate authority, and implement it across your agency. This chapter covers each step.

## 8.1 Circulating Drafts for Feedback

A MOP written in isolation by the development team will contain blind spots. The people who execute the procedures daily will catch errors, omissions, and impracticalities that the drafting team missed. Circulate your draft through three review rounds.

### 8.1.1 Internal Review Process

Route the draft MOP to every division and unit within its scope. Give reviewers two weeks minimum for a full MOP and one week for individual chapter updates.

**Who reviews:** - All Division Chiefs and Section Heads within the MOP's scope - Selected Staff Officers (especially those with the most experience in key procedures) - The Administrative Officer (for administrative procedures) - The Finance Officer (for financial management procedures) - The HR Officer (for human resource procedures) - The Procurement Officer (for procurement procedures)

**What to ask reviewers:**

Provide each reviewer with a feedback form that asks specific questions:

| Question | Purpose |
|---|---|
| Are the procedures described accurately? | Verifies the MOP matches actual practice |
| Are any steps missing? | Identifies gaps |
| Are any steps unnecessary? | Identifies over-documentation |
| Are the forms appropriate and usable? | Tests form design |
| Can a new employee follow these procedures without oral explanation? | Tests clarity and completeness |
| Are the turnaround times realistic? | Validates performance standards |

| Question | Purpose |
|---|---|
| Are the responsible persons correctly identified? | Verifies accountability assignments |

### 8.1.2 External Expert Review

For a first-time MOP or a major revision, bring in external reviewers with expertise your internal team may lack:

- **Legal reviewer.** A lawyer or legal officer who can verify legal compliance, particularly with BAA 13, BAA 17, BAA 84, and your enabling BAA.
- **Operations management expert.** A professional with experience in government operations manuals who can evaluate the MOP's structure, completeness, and usability.
- **COA representative.** If possible, invite an auditor to review the financial management and accountability chapters. Their feedback now prevents audit findings later.

External review typically takes two to four weeks. Budget for this time in your work plan.

### 8.1.3 Managing Conflicting Feedback

Different reviewers will give different – sometimes contradictory – feedback. The Staff Officer thinks the procedure is too detailed. The Division Chief thinks it is not detailed enough. The Legal Expert wants more legal references. The Technical Writer wants fewer.

Manage conflicts with a structured approach:

1. **Compile all feedback** in a single matrix (see Section 8.2.1)
2. **Categorize each item** as factual correction, preference, or substantive disagreement
3. **Accept all factual corrections** without discussion
4. **Note preferences** but do not automatically adopt them – consistency matters more than individual preference
5. **Escalate substantive disagreements** to the Team Leader for resolution
6. **Consult the approving authority** when disagreements involve policy decisions

## 8.2 Incorporating Feedback

### 8.2.1 Feedback Tracking Matrix

Track every piece of feedback in a structured matrix:

| No. | Reviewer | Chapter/ Section | Feedback | Category | Decision | Revised? |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Admin Division Chief | Ch. VI, Sec. 6.2 | Step 3 should specify two-hour turnaround | Substantive | Accepted | Yes |
| 2 | Finance Officer | Ch. IV, Sec. 4.3 | Voucher form number is wrong | Factual correction | Accepted | Yes |
| 3 | Staff Officer A | Ch. VI, Sec. 6.1 | Too many steps. Can we combine Steps 4-5? | Preference | Rejected (different responsible persons) | No |
| 4 | Legal Expert | Ch. III, Sec. 3.2 | BAA 17 citation is incorrect | Factual correction | Accepted | Yes |
| 5 | External Reviewer | Ch. VII | Missing procurement threshold reference | Substantive | Accepted | Yes |

This matrix serves two purposes: it tracks the disposition of every comment (so no feedback is lost), and it documents why specific decisions were made (so future reviewers understand the rationale).

### 8.2.2 Revision Protocols

Apply revisions systematically:

1. **Batch revisions by chapter.** Address all feedback for one chapter before moving to the next. This prevents inconsistencies that arise from piecemeal editing.
2. **Track changes.** Use tracked changes (in word processors) or redline notation (in markdown) so reviewers can verify their feedback was addressed.
3. **Re-verify cross-references.** After incorporating revisions, re-check all cross-references. A change in one chapter often ripples to others.
4. **Second review.** After major revisions, circulate the affected chapters for a second review. This should be faster (one week) because reviewers are only checking their specific feedback.

# 8.3 Authority Approval

## 8.3.1 Who Approves the MOP

The approving authority depends on the MOP's scope:

| MOP Scope | Approving Authority |
|---|---|
| Ministry-wide MOP | Minister (or equivalent agency head) |
| Division MOP | Undersecretary or Assistant Secretary |
| Office MOP | Director II or Division Chief |
| Cross-agency MOP (e.g., shared services) | Chief Minister or designated coordinating authority |

The approving authority should receive:

- The final MOP document
- The Feedback Tracking Matrix showing all feedback received and how it was addressed
- The Mandate-to-Procedure Traceability Matrix (Chapter 6)
- A one-page executive summary highlighting key features, changes from previous versions (if applicable), and implementation recommendations

## 8.3.2 Approval Documentation

Document the approval formally. The approving authority issues:

1. **An approval memorandum or office order.** This document states: (a) the MOP is approved, (b) the effective date, (c) which previous versions or SOPs it supersedes, and (d) the requirement for all staff to comply.
2. **A signed MOP cover page.** The approving authority signs the MOP's cover page or approval page, affirming that the document has been reviewed and approved.

Keep the signed approval documents in a permanent file. They establish the MOP's official status and effective date.

## 8.4 Staff Orientation and Training

An approved MOP is worth nothing if staff do not know it exists, cannot find it, or do not understand how to use it. Training is not optional. It is the bridge between documentation and implementation.

### 8.4.1 Designing the Orientation Program

Design a structured orientation program that covers:

| Session | Duration | Audience | Content |
|---|---|---|---|
| **MOP overview** | 2 hours | All staff | Purpose of the MOP, overall structure, how to navigate it, where to find it, how to request amendments |
| **Division-specific procedures** | 4 hours | Division/unit staff | Detailed walkthrough of each procedure in the staff's functional area, including hands-on practice with forms |
| **Supervisory procedures** | 3 hours | Division Chiefs, Section Heads | Review and approval procedures, quality criteria, performance monitoring, escalation protocols |
| **Administrative procedures** | 2 hours | Admin and support staff | Reception, routing, tracking, filing, and delivery procedures |

### 8.4.2 Training Sessions by Role

Tailor training content to each role:

**For Staff Officers (execution level):** - Focus on the workflow tables they will execute - Walk through each step of their assigned procedures - Practice filling out the forms they will use - Review the quality criteria for their outputs - Clarify where to find help when they encounter unusual situations

**For Division Chiefs (review level):** - Focus on the review criteria and quality standards - Practice evaluating draft outputs against the quality criteria tables - Review the escalation protocols for delays - Discuss how to use performance KPIs to manage their division

**For the Director and Agency Head (approval level):** - Focus on the strategic purpose of the MOP - Review the turnaround time standards and escalation protocols - Discuss performance monitoring and quarterly review processes - Clarify delegation of authority for MOP-related approvals

### 8.4.3 Hands-On Practice with Forms and Workflows

Lecture-based training does not build competence. Hands-on practice does. Include these exercises in every training session:

**Exercise 1: Complete the forms.** Give each participant blank copies of every form they will use. Walk through each field. Have them fill in the form using a sample scenario.

**Exercise 2: Walk the workflow.** Simulate a complete procedure from Reception to Delivery. Assign roles. Give the "Administrative Officer" a sample request. Have them log it, attach the Referral and Action Slip, and forward it. Continue through each step until the output is "delivered."

**Exercise 3: Find it in the MOP.** Give participants scenarios and ask them to find the relevant procedure in the MOP. This builds familiarity with the document's structure and navigation.

# 8.5 Rollout Plan

## 8.5.1 Phased vs. Full Implementation

Choose your rollout approach based on agency size and readiness:

**Full implementation** works for small agencies (fewer than 50 staff) where training can reach everyone within two weeks. Set an effectivity date. On that date, the MOP applies to all operations.

**Phased implementation** works for larger agencies. Roll out by division or by chapter:

| Phase | Timeline | Scope |
|---|---|---|
| Phase 1: Weeks 1-2 | Administrative procedures (Ch. I, II, VIII) | All divisions |
| Phase 2: Weeks 3-4 | HR and finance procedures (Ch. III, IV) | All divisions |
| Phase 3: Weeks 5-8 | Service delivery procedures (Ch. VI) | One division at a time |
| Phase 4: Weeks 9-10 | Procurement and planning (Ch. V, VII) | All divisions |
| Phase 5: Week 11-12 | Full integration and monitoring | All divisions |

Phased rollout allows you to identify and fix problems before they affect the entire agency.

## 8.5.2 Distribution and Access

Make the MOP accessible. Inaccessible MOPs are unused MOPs.

**Physical copies:** - Print at least one copy per division - Place copies in accessible locations (not locked in the Division Chief's cabinet) - Use binders that allow easy replacement of updated pages

**Digital copies:** - Upload to the agency's shared drive or intranet - Ensure all staff know the file location - Use PDF format for the official version (prevents unauthorized edits) - Maintain an editable version (Word or Markdown) for authorized amendments

**Quick reference materials:** - Print laminated one-page summaries of the most common procedures - Post workflow diagrams for high-frequency processes on office walls - Create pocket-sized cards with frequently used form references

### 8.5.3 Communication Strategy

Announce the MOP's implementation through multiple channels:

1. **Agency-wide memorandum** from the head announcing the approved MOP, its effective date, and the requirement for compliance
2. **Division briefings** where Division Chiefs explain the MOP to their staff
3. **Bulletin board postings** with the MOP overview and key procedures
4. **Digital notification** via email or group chat to all staff

> **The 90-day rule.** Expect full compliance within 90 days of implementation, not immediately. During the first 90 days, focus on guidance and coaching rather than enforcement. After 90 days, the MOP becomes the standard against which all operations are measured. This grace period builds buy-in and allows staff to develop new habits.

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*Back to Table of Contents*

# 09

# Monitoring, Evaluation, and Continuous Improvement

A MOP is not a finished product. It is a living document. Procedures that work today may become bottlenecks tomorrow. Laws change. Technology evolves. Staff develop better methods. A MOP that is not monitored, evaluated, and updated becomes a relic – present on the shelf but absent from practice.

This chapter establishes the systems that keep your MOP relevant and effective.

## 9.1 KPIs for MOP Effectiveness

Chapter 7 defined KPIs for individual output quality and processing efficiency. This section defines KPIs that measure the MOP itself – how well it serves as an operational guide.

### 9.1.1 Adherence Rate

**Definition:** The percentage of transactions that follow the MOP's prescribed procedures.

**Measurement:** Conduct monthly spot checks. Select five to ten recent transactions per procedure. Trace each transaction against the workflow table. Count the steps that were followed correctly.

**Formula:** (Steps followed correctly / Total steps checked) x 100

**Target:** 85% in the first six months. 95% after one year.

**What low adherence tells you:** If staff consistently skip or modify steps, the MOP may be impractical, unclear, or missing essential procedures. Investigate before enforcing.

### 9.1.2 Error and Rework Rate

**Definition:** The percentage of outputs that contain errors requiring correction after the Review or Approval Stage.

**Measurement:** Track every output returned for revision. Record the reason (factual error, incomplete analysis, formatting, missing documentation).

**Formula:** (Outputs returned for revision / Total outputs) x 100

**Target:** Below 20% in the first six months. Below 10% after one year.

**What high error rates tell you:** If certain procedures consistently produce errors, the execution instructions may be unclear, the quality criteria may be ambiguous, or staff may need additional training.

### 9.1.3 Average Processing Time

**Definition:** The average time from receipt of a request to delivery of the completed output.

**Measurement:** Calculate from the Document Tracking Log (Form 4). Use the date received and date delivered fields.

**Formula:** Sum of processing times / Number of outputs

**Target:** At or below the turnaround standard for each output type (Chapter 7, Section 7.3).

**What long processing times tell you:** Consistently exceeding turnaround standards points to bottlenecks. Analyze the active-to-wait time ratio. If wait time is the culprit, the problem is routing or availability, not execution.

### 9.1.4 Client Feedback Scores

**Definition:** The satisfaction level of the people who receive your agency's outputs.

**Measurement:** Use post-service feedback forms (for external clients) or periodic internal surveys (for internal clients).

**Target:** 4.0 or higher on a 5-point scale.

**What low scores tell you:** Client dissatisfaction may reflect output quality, processing time, communication, or all three. Disaggregate feedback to identify the specific driver.

## 9.2 User Feedback Mechanisms

Performance data tells you what is happening. User feedback tells you why. Build multiple channels for feedback.

### 9.2.1 Feedback Forms

Create a simple one-page feedback form that staff can submit at any time. Include:

| Field | Description |
|---|---|
| **Your name and position** | Optional for internal forms, required for external |
| **Procedure reference** | Which MOP chapter and section are you commenting on? |
| **Type of feedback** | Error in the MOP / Suggestion for improvement / Request for clarification / Report of impractical procedure |
| **Description** | Describe the issue or suggestion in detail |
| **Proposed solution** | If you have one, describe how you would fix the issue |

Place blank forms in common areas. Accept digital submissions via email. Designate a specific person to receive and log all feedback.

### 9.2.2 Focus Group Discussions

Conduct focus group discussions (FGDs) with staff twice a year: once at the six-month mark after implementation and once at the annual review. Group participants by role:

- **Staff officers FGD:** Focus on execution-level procedures. Are the workflow tables clear? Are the forms workable? Are turnaround times realistic?
- **Supervisors FGD:** Focus on review and approval procedures. Are the quality criteria useful? Do escalation protocols work? Is monitoring practical?
- **Administrative staff FGD:** Focus on reception, routing, and delivery procedures. Is the tracking system working? Are forms easy to fill out?

Document each FGD's findings. Present them at the quarterly MOP effectiveness review.

### 9.2.3 Anonymous Suggestion Systems

Some staff will not provide candid feedback through formal channels. An anonymous suggestion box (physical or digital) captures feedback that formal channels miss.

**Rules for anonymous suggestions:**

- All suggestions are reviewed by the MOP Development Team (or its successor)
- No suggestion is ignored, even if the answer is “no change needed”
- Responses to suggestions are posted on the bulletin board without identifying the suggester
- Patterns in anonymous suggestions trigger formal review of the affected procedures

## 9.3 Periodic Review Schedule

Build a review schedule into the MOP itself. Three types of reviews keep the MOP current.

### 9.3.1 Quarterly Quick Reviews

**Frequency:** Every three months. **Duration:** Half day. **Participants:** Team Leader (or MOP custodian), one representative per division.

**Agenda:** 1. Review performance KPIs for the quarter 2. Review feedback received during the quarter 3. Identify procedures requiring minor amendments 4. Review status of any pending amendments 5. Check for new legislation that may affect the MOP

**Output:** Quarterly MOP Status Report (one to two pages) submitted to the agency head.

### 9.3.2 Annual Comprehensive Reviews

**Frequency:** Every 12 months from the MOP's effective date. **Duration:** Two to three days. **Participants:** Full MOP Development Team or designated review committee.

**Agenda:** 1. Review all performance data for the year 2. Review all user feedback (forms, FGDs, anonymous suggestions) 3. Review all audit findings related to MOP compliance 4. Assess each chapter for currency and accuracy 5. Identify procedures that need revision, addition, or removal 6. Review the Mandate-to-Procedure Traceability Matrix against any new legislation 7. Draft amendments for approval

**Output:** Annual MOP Review Report with recommended amendments. Submit to the approving authority.

### 9.3.3 Triggered Reviews

Certain events trigger immediate MOP reviews outside the regular schedule:

| Trigger | Review Scope |
|---|---|
| New BAA enacted that affects agency mandate | Chapters affected by the new mandate |
| Organizational restructuring | All chapters |

| Trigger | Review Scope |
|---|---|
| COA audit finding citing MOP deficiency | Specific procedures cited in the finding |
| Major system change (new IT system, new facility) | Procedures affected by the system change |
| Significant increase in processing errors | Specific procedures with high error rates |
| Staff complaint rate exceeds 5% | Procedures cited in complaints |

Triggered reviews follow the same process as annual reviews but are limited in scope to the affected procedures.

## 9.4 Amendment Procedures

Not every issue requires a full MOP revision. Build a tiered amendment process.

### 9.4.1 Minor Amendments

**Definition:** Changes that correct errors, update form numbers, adjust position titles, or clarify existing procedures without changing the substance.

**Process:** 1. The MOP custodian identifies the amendment 2. The custodian drafts the correction 3. The Team Leader or Division Chief reviews and endorses 4. The Director or agency head approves 5. Updated pages are distributed with an amendment notice 6. The change log is updated

**Timeline:** Two weeks or less.

### 9.4.2 Major Revisions

**Definition:** Changes that add new procedures, remove existing procedures, significantly alter workflow steps, change accountability assignments, or revise quality standards.

**Process:** 1. The need for revision is documented (audit finding, user feedback, new legislation) 2. The MOP Development Team (or review committee) drafts the revision 3. The draft is circulated for internal review (one week) 4. Feedback is incorporated 5. The approving authority reviews and approves 6. Staff orientation is conducted on the revised procedures 7. Updated chapters are distributed 8. The change log and version number are updated

**Timeline:** Four to eight weeks.

### 9.4.3 Version Control and Change Logs

Maintain a change log at the front of the MOP (immediately after the cover page):

| Version | Date | Chapter/ Section | Description of Change | Approved By |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1.0 | 2026-04-01 | All | Original version | Minister |
| 1.1 | 2026-07-15 | | | Director II |

| Version | Date | Chapter/ Section | Description of Change | Approved By |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | Ch. IV, Sec. 4.3 | Updated voucher processing procedure per BAA 84 amendment | |
| 1.2 | 2026-10-01 | Ch. VI, Sec. 6.2 | Added procedure for processing digital submissions | Director II |
| 2.0 | 2027-04-01 | All | Annual comprehensive revision | Minister |

**Numbering convention:** - Minor amendments increment the decimal: 1.0, 1.1, 1.2 - Major revisions increment the whole number: 1.0, 2.0, 3.0 - Each version supersedes all previous versions

## 9.5 Building a Culture of Continuous Improvement

Systems and schedules are necessary but not sufficient. Continuous improvement requires a culture where staff view the MOP as a tool they own, not a burden imposed on them.

**Five practices that build this culture:**

**1. Celebrate improvements.** When a staff member's feedback leads to a MOP amendment that saves time or improves quality, acknowledge it publicly. Name the contributor. Describe the improvement. Show the impact.

**2. Involve staff in reviews.** Do not limit MOP reviews to the development team. Rotate staff members through the quarterly review process. When staff participate in reviews, they develop ownership.

**3. Make the MOP visible.** Post workflow diagrams on walls. Print quick-reference cards. Include MOP references in staff meeting agendas. The MOP should be present in daily operations, not hidden in a cabinet.

**4. Link performance evaluation to MOP compliance.** Include MOP adherence as a factor in performance evaluations. Staff who consistently follow procedures and suggest improvements should be recognized. Staff who consistently deviate without justification should receive coaching.

**5. Lead by example.** When supervisors follow the MOP's review and approval procedures faithfully, staff follow the execution procedures. When supervisors bypass the MOP, staff learn that the MOP is optional.

> **The goal.** A mature MOP system is self-improving. Staff identify problems. Feedback mechanisms capture them. Review processes evaluate them. Amendment procedures fix them. Training sessions embed the fixes. Performance metrics confirm the improvement. This cycle, once established, runs continuously with minimal external intervention.

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*Back to Table of Contents*

# 10

# Adapting MOPs by Entity Size

Not every BARMM entity needs a 150-page manual. A Ministry with 500 staff, 15 divisions, and a legislative mandate spanning education, health, or finance needs a comprehensive MOP. A two-person office handling document routing needs a focused, streamlined manual. Forcing the same format on both wastes resources and produces documents that are either bloated or inadequate.

This chapter provides scaling guidance for three entity sizes: Provincial (full Ministry or Commission), Division, and Office.

## 10.1 Why One Size Does Not Fit All

The nine-chapter MOP structure (Chapter 4) is designed for full-scale Ministries, Offices, and Agencies. But BARMM contains entities of vastly different sizes and complexity:

| Entity Type | Typical Staff Size | Number of Functions | Examples |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Ministry** | 100-500+ | 15-30+ | MBHTE, MILG, MFBM, MPA |
| **Commission** | 30-100 | 8-15 | BWC (BAA 8), BHRC (BAA 9), BYC (BAA 10) |
| **Bureau or Office** | 10-30 | 5-10 | Policy Research and Legal Services, Bills and Index Division |
| **Division within a Ministry** | 5-20 | 3-8 | Administrative Division, Finance Division, Planning Division |
| **Small Office or Unit** | 2-5 | 1-3 | Records Unit, Reception Office, Supply Unit |

A MOP that is too long for its entity will not be read. A MOP that is too short for its entity will not be useful. Match the MOP to the entity.

## 10.2 Provincial MOP (Full 9 Chapters, 80-150 Pages)

The Provincial MOP is the comprehensive version. It covers all nine standard chapters with full detail. Use this format for Ministries, Commissions, and agencies with broad mandates and large staff complements.

### 10.2.1 When to Use the Full Format

Use the full nine-chapter Provincial MOP when:

- The entity has 50 or more staff members
- The entity has five or more functional divisions
- The entity delivers 10 or more distinct services or outputs
- The entity's mandate spans multiple functional areas (HR, finance, service delivery, policy, procurement)
- The entity reports to multiple oversight bodies (Parliament, COA, Chief Minister's Office)
- The entity has its own budget allocation and procurement authority

### 10.2.2 Structure and Content Guide

Every chapter in the Provincial MOP is fully developed:

| Chapter | Content Depth | Estimated Pages |
|---|---|---|
| **I: Introduction** | Full background, legal basis, scope, definitions | 5-10 |
| **II: Organizational Structure** | Full org chart, all position descriptions, delegation of authority | 10-15 |
| **III: HR Management** | All HR procedures from recruitment to separation | 15-25 |
| **IV: Financial Management** | Full budget cycle, disbursement, reporting | 10-20 |
| **V: Planning and Programming** | Annual planning cycle, performance targeting, PPAS development | 8-12 |

| Chapter | Content Depth | Estimated Pages |
|---|---|---|
| **VI: Service Delivery** | All service delivery procedures in four-column PRLS format | 20-40 |
| **VII: Procurement and Property** | Full procurement procedures, property management, inventory | 10-15 |
| **VIII: Reporting and Accountability** | All internal and external reports, records management | 8-12 |
| **IX: Annexes** | All forms, templates, charts, legal references | 15-50 |
| **Total** | | **80-150** |

### 10.2.3 Sample Chapter Outline

Here is a sample outline for a Provincial MOP for a Ministry (using MBHTE as an illustrative example):

**Chapter VI: Service Delivery** (the core chapter)

- 6.1 Overview of MBHTE Service Delivery Functions
- 6.2 Category A: Education Policy Outputs
- 6.2.1 Procedure for Developing Curriculum Guidelines
- 6.2.2 Procedure for Issuing Education Standards
- 6.2.3 Procedure for Processing School Accreditation
- 6.3 Category B: Administrative and Management Outputs
- 6.3.1 Procedure for Processing Personnel Actions
- 6.3.2 Procedure for Processing Budget Requests
- 6.3.3 Procedure for Managing Official Correspondence
- 6.4 Category C: Research and Information Outputs
- 6.4.1 Procedure for Producing Education Statistics Reports
- 6.4.2 Procedure for Conducting School Performance Assessments
- 6.4.3 Procedure for Preparing Needs Assessment Reports
- 6.5 Category D: Service Delivery Outputs
- 6.5.1 Procedure for Processing Scholarship Applications
- 6.5.2 Procedure for Issuing School Operating Permits

- 6.5.3 Procedure for Processing Equivalency and Recognition Requests

Each procedure follows the PRLS four-column format with the six-stage workflow (Reception through Delivery) as demonstrated in Chapter 5.

## 10.3 Division MOP (5-6 Chapters, 40-80 Pages)

The Division MOP covers a single division within a larger agency. It documents the division's internal procedures while referencing the parent agency's MOP for enterprise-wide functions like HR, finance, and procurement.

### 10.3.1 When to Use the Division Format

Use the Division MOP when:

- The entity is a division, bureau, or office within a larger Ministry
- The entity has 10 to 50 staff members
- The entity performs 5 to 15 distinct procedures
- The parent agency has its own MOP for enterprise-wide functions
- The division needs to document division-specific procedures not covered in the parent MOP

### 10.3.2 Which Chapters to Include

A Division MOP includes five or six chapters:

| Chapter | Content | Reference to Parent MOP |
|---|---|---|
| **I: Introduction** | Division background, mandate (traced to parent agency mandate), scope | References parent MOP for agency-wide context |
| **II: Organizational Structure** | Division org chart, position descriptions, internal delegation | References parent MOP Chapter II for agency-wide structure |
| **III: Service Delivery** | All division-specific procedures in PRLS format | This is the core chapter – fully detailed |
| **IV: Internal Administration** | Division-level admin: records, routing, filing, supplies | References parent MOP Chapters III, IV, VII for HR, finance, procurement |
| **V: Reporting and Quality** | Division reports, KPIs, quality criteria | References parent MOP Chapter VIII for agency-wide reporting |

| Chapter | Content | Reference to Parent MOP |
|---|---|---|
| **VI: Annexes** | Division-specific forms, templates, references | References parent MOP Annexes for agency-wide forms |

### 10.3.3 What to Consolidate

In a Division MOP, consolidate enterprise-wide functions by reference:

**Do not duplicate** procedures for HR, finance, or procurement that are already in the parent MOP. Instead, write: "For recruitment procedures, refer to [Parent Agency] MOP, Chapter III, Section 3.2." This prevents inconsistency and reduces maintenance burden.

**Do document** procedures that are unique to the division or that add division-specific steps to enterprise-wide procedures. For example, if the parent MOP says "Submit budget requests to the Finance Division," the Division MOP should document how the division prepares its budget request before submission.

**Do include** the division's internal routing, delegation, and quality review procedures even if the parent MOP has agency-wide versions. Divisions need their own specific workflow tables showing who within the division handles each step.

## 10.4 Office MOP (3-4 Chapters, 20-40 Pages)

The Office MOP is the most focused version. It covers a small office, unit, or section with a narrow mandate and limited staff.

### 10.4.1 When to Use the Office Format

Use the Office MOP when:

- The entity has fewer than 10 staff members
- The entity performs 1 to 5 core procedures
- The entity's functions are primarily administrative or support-oriented
- The parent agency's MOP covers most enterprise-wide functions
- The office needs a focused, quick-reference document

### 10.4.2 Essential Chapters

An Office MOP includes three or four chapters:

| Chapter | Content | Estimated Pages |
|---|---|---|
| **I: Introduction and Organization** | Combined introduction and org structure. Office mandate, org chart, position descriptions, delegation. | 5-8 |
| **II: Standard Operating Procedures** | All office procedures in PRLS format. This is the core chapter. | 10-20 |
| **III: Forms and References** | All forms used, with instructions. References to parent agency MOP for enterprise functions. | 5-10 |
| **IV: Quality and Monitoring** | (Optional) Simple quality criteria and tracking method for high-frequency outputs. | 3-5 |
| **Total** | | **20-40** |

### 10.4.3 Streamlined Procedures

In an Office MOP, streamline the PRLS six-stage workflow to match the office's simpler reality:

**Full PRLS workflow (6 stages):** Reception > Evaluation/Delegation > Execution > Review > Approval > Delivery

**Streamlined workflow for a small office (3-4 stages):** Reception > Execution > Review/Approval > Delivery

In a small office, the same person may receive, evaluate, and delegate. The supervisor may review and approve in a single step. The workflow table should reflect this reality. Do not add artificial steps to match the full PRLS format. The principles remain the same – accountability at every step, forms for tracking, quality criteria for outputs – but the number of handoffs is fewer.

**Example: Streamlined procedure for a Records Unit**

| Step | Responsible Person | Action/Procedure | Output/Form Used |
|---|---|---|---|
| **RECEPTION** | | | |
| 1 | Records Officer | Receives incoming document from courier, mail, or walk-in. Checks for completeness (all pages, attachments, proper addressing). Stamps with date and time received. Logs in the Incoming Document Register. | Incoming Document Register updated. |
| **EXECUTION** | | | |
| 2 | Records Officer | Classifies the document by subject and urgency. Identifies the appropriate recipient (Division or Office). Prepares a Routing Slip noting the classification and recommended action. | Routing Slip prepared. |
| **REVIEW/ APPROVAL** | | | |
| 3 | Records Unit Head | Reviews the classification and routing recommendation. If correct, initials the Routing Slip. If incorrect, re-classifies and annotates. | Initialed Routing Slip. |

| Step | Responsible Person | Action/Procedure | Output/Form Used |
|---|---|---|---|
| **DELIVERY** | | | |
| 4 | Records Officer | Delivers the document with the Routing Slip to the designated recipient. Obtains signature on the Delivery Log. Updates the Incoming Document Register with the delivery date and recipient. | Delivery Log signed. Register updated. |

Four steps. Four clear responsibilities. Two forms. Complete traceability. This is the PRLS model scaled to a two-person office.

## 10.5 Decision Matrix: Choosing the Right Format

Use this decision matrix to determine which MOP format your entity needs:

| Factor | Provincial MOP | Division MOP | Office MOP |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Staff size** | 50+ | 10-50 | Under 10 |
| **Number of core procedures** | 15+ | 5-15 | 1-5 |
| **Has own budget authority** | Yes | Usually no | No |
| **Has own procurement authority** | Yes | Sometimes | No |
| **Has own HR authority** | Yes | Usually no | No |
| **Reports directly to Chief Minister/ Parliament** | Yes | No | No |
| **Parent MOP exists** | N/A (this IS the parent) | Yes | Yes |
| **Recommended page count** | 80-150 | 40-80 | 20-40 |
| **Recommended chapters** | 9 | 5-6 | 3-4 |
| **Development time** | 8-12 weeks | 4-8 weeks | 2-4 weeks |

When in doubt, start with the Division format. You can always expand to Provincial if the division's scope warrants it, and it is easier to expand than to cut down.

## 10.6 Scaling Up: From Office MOP to Provincial MOP

Some entities start small and grow. A commission that begins with 15 staff may grow to 80. An office that starts with three procedures may acquire seven more through legislative expansion. Build your MOP with scaling in mind.

**Scaling principles:**

**1. Use the nine-chapter structure from the start, even if some chapters are thin.** An Office MOP can include Chapter III: HR Management with a single paragraph: "For all HR procedures, refer to [Parent Agency] MOP, Chapter III." When the office grows and develops its own HR procedures, the chapter is already there. You add content rather than restructure the document.

**2. Keep output categories consistent.** If you start with two output categories and later need four, the existing categories should remain stable. Add new categories without renaming or renumbering the originals.

**3. Version your MOP from day one.** Even a 20-page Office MOP should have a change log and version number. This practice scales naturally as the MOP grows.

**4. Use the PRLS format from the start.** Do not use an informal format for a small MOP and then convert to PRLS later. Converting is expensive. Start with four-column workflow tables, even if you only have four rows. The format scales from two-step procedures to twenty-step procedures without redesign.

**5. Document your mandate-to-procedure traceability from the start.** A small office may have only five entries in the Mandate-to-Procedure Traceability Matrix. But the matrix structure is in place. As the entity grows and takes on new mandates, new entries are added without restructuring.

> **The goal.** Build a MOP that can grow without being rewritten. A well-structured 30-page Office MOP can evolve into a 100-page Provincial MOP through incremental addition, not wholesale replacement. The PRLS format, the nine-chapter structure, and the traceability matrix make this possible.

*Back to Table of Contents*

# Glossary

**Action Slip.** See *Referral and Action Slip*.

**Administrative Code.** See *BAA 13*.

**Amendment.** A formal change to a MOP. Minor amendments correct errors or update references. Major amendments add, remove, or significantly alter procedures. See Chapter 9, Section 9.4.

**Approving Authority.** The official who has the power to approve a MOP or a specific output. For Ministry-wide MOPs, this is the Minister. For Division MOPs, the Undersecretary or Assistant Secretary. For Office MOPs, the Director or Division Chief.

**BAA.** Bangsamoro Autonomy Act. A law enacted by the Bangsamoro Transition Authority Parliament. BAAs are the primary legislative outputs of the BTA and establish the legal framework for Bangsamoro governance.

**BAA 8.** The Bangsamoro Autonomy Act that created the Bangsamoro Women Commission (BWC) and defined its mandate to mainstream gender in all government programs.

**BAA 9.** The Bangsamoro Autonomy Act that created the Bangsamoro Human Rights Commission and defined its mandate to investigate human rights violations and promote human rights awareness.

**BAA 10.** The Bangsamoro Autonomy Act that created the Bangsamoro Youth Commission (BYC) and defined its mandate to promote youth development and represent youth interests in governance.

**BAA 13.** The Bangsamoro Administrative Code. The foundational law that defines the organizational structure, mandates, and functions of all BARMM Ministries, Offices, and Agencies.

**BAA 17.** The Bangsamoro Civil Service Code. Governs human resources management across all BARMM agencies, including recruitment, appointment, promotion, discipline, and separation.

**BAA 18.** The Bangsamoro Education Code. Defines the mandate and functions of the Ministry of Basic, Higher, and Technical Education (MBHTE).

**BAA 35.** The Bangsamoro Electoral Code. Governs electoral processes in the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region.

**BAA 82.** The Bangsamoro Labor Code. Defines labor standards, employment procedures, and worker protections in the BARMM.

**BAA 84.** The Budget System Act. Governs budget preparation, execution, and accountability for all BARMM agencies.

**BARMM.** Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao. The autonomous political entity in the southern Philippines established by the Bangsamoro Organic Law (Republic Act No. 11054).

**BDP 2023-2028.** The Second Bangsamoro Development Plan covering the period 2023 to 2028. Provides the strategic framework for development across all sectors of the Bangsamoro region.

**BOL.** Bangsamoro Organic Law. Republic Act No. 11054. The foundational law that created the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region and defines its government structure, powers, and territory.

**Bottleneck.** A step in a workflow where documents or transactions accumulate because the step cannot process them as fast as they arrive. Common causes include understaffing, excessive approval requirements, and unavailable approvers.

**BTA.** Bangsamoro Transition Authority. The interim governing body of the BARMM during the transition period, exercising both executive and legislative powers.

**Change Log.** A record maintained at the front of the MOP that documents every amendment, including version number, date, affected section, description of change, and approving authority. See Chapter 9, Section 9.4.3.

**COA.** Commission on Audit. The constitutional body that examines and audits the accounts and expenditures of all government agencies, including BARMM entities.

**Continuous Improvement.** The ongoing effort to improve processes, outputs, and systems through incremental changes based on data, feedback, and review. The MOP review cycle (quarterly quick reviews, annual comprehensive reviews, and triggered reviews) is the mechanism for continuous improvement. See Chapter 9, Section 9.5.

**Delegation of Authority.** A formal document that specifies who acts in place of the primary authority when that person is absent. Essential for preventing bottlenecks caused by unavailable approvers.

**Division MOP.** A MOP covering a single division within a larger agency. Typically 40-80 pages with 5-6 chapters. See Chapter 10, Section 10.3.

**Document Tracking Log.** A register that records all documents received and processed by the office, including dates received, assigned, completed, and delivered. Also called Form 4 in the PRLS MOP Model. See Chapter 5, Section 5.5.4.

**Enabling BAA.** The specific Bangsamoro Autonomy Act that created an agency and defined its mandate. Distinct from BAA 13 (the Administrative Code), which provides the general administrative framework.

**Escalation Protocol.** A procedure that activates when processing exceeds the standard turnaround time. Three levels: near deadline (notify Division Chief), at deadline (notify Director), past deadline (notify agency head). See Chapter 7, Section 7.3.3.

**Fishbone Diagram.** Also called an Ishikawa diagram. A visual tool that maps all possible causes of a problem into categories (People, Process, Policy, Technology, Resources, Communication). Used in root cause analysis during the information gathering phase. See Chapter 3, Section 3.5.2.

**Five Whys (5 Whys).** A root cause analysis technique that asks "why?" repeatedly until the fundamental cause of a problem is identified. See Chapter 3, Section 3.5.1.

**Four-Column Workflow Table.** The core documentation format in the PRLS MOP Model. Columns: Step Number, Responsible Person/Unit, Action/Procedure, Output/Form Used. See Chapter 5, Section 5.3.

**Gap Analysis.** A comparison between current state and desired state that identifies missing, outdated, conflicting, or incomplete procedures. See Chapter 3, Section 3.5.3.

**Hierarchical Approval Flow.** The six-stage workflow in the PRLS MOP Model: Reception, Evaluation/Delegation, Execution, Review, Approval, Delivery. See Chapter 5, Section 5.4.

**KPI.** Key Performance Indicator. A measurable value that demonstrates how effectively a process or output achieves its target. See Chapter 7, Section 7.4.

**Mandate-to-Procedure Traceability Matrix.** A table that links every MOP procedure to a specific legal mandate from BAA 13 or the enabling BAA. Proves that every procedure serves a legally defined purpose. See Chapter 6, Section 6.4.

**MOA.** Ministry, Office, or Agency. The generic term for any government entity within the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region.

**MOP.** Manual of Operations. A comprehensive reference document that defines how a MOA performs its functions, translating legal mandates into actionable, step-by-step procedures.

**MOP Development Team.** The team responsible for creating or revising a MOP. Consists of six roles: Team Leader, Subject Matter Experts, Quality Assurance Specialist, Technical Writer, Legal Expert, and Graphic Designer. See Chapter 2, Section 2.2.

**Needs Assessment.** A structured evaluation that defines the scope of a MOP, identifies existing documentation, maps current processes, and identifies gaps. See Chapter 2, Section 2.3.

**Office MOP.** A MOP covering a small office, unit, or section. Typically 20-40 pages with 3-4 chapters. See Chapter 10, Section 10.4.

**Output-Based Organization.** The PRLS MOP principle of organizing procedures around the tangible products (outputs) an agency delivers, rather than around organizational units. See Chapter 5, Section 5.2.

**PPAS.** Programs, Projects, Activities, and Services. The standard categorization for government work used in budget planning and performance management.

**PRLS.** Policy Research and Legal Services. The office within the Bangsamoro Parliament that provides policy research, legal analysis, and legislative support. The PRLS MOP format is the gold standard for procedural documentation in this guidebook.

**PRLS MOP Model.** The procedural documentation format used by the Policy Research and Legal Services of the Bangsamoro Parliament. Characterized by output-based organization, four-column workflow tables, hierarchical approval flow, and standardized forms. See Chapter 5.

**Provincial MOP.** The most comprehensive MOP format, covering all nine standard chapters. Typically 80-150 pages. Used for Ministries, Commissions, and agencies with broad mandates. See Chapter 10, Section 10.2.

**Quality Criteria.** Specific, measurable standards that define what constitutes an acceptable output. Include criteria for accuracy, completeness, format compliance, legal soundness, and timeliness. See Chapter 7, Section 7.2.

**Referral and Action Slip.** A routing control document attached to every incoming request. Contains tracking information, assignment instructions, and completion records. Also called Form 1 in the PRLS MOP Model. See Chapter 5, Section 5.5.1.

**Root Cause Analysis.** A problem-solving method that seeks to identify the fundamental cause of a problem rather than its symptoms. Techniques include the 5 Whys and fishbone diagrams. See Chapter 3, Section 3.5.

**Routing Slip.** A form that tracks a document's movement within an office. Records each handoff with date, time, action taken, and next recipient. Also called Form 3 in the PRLS MOP Model. See Chapter 5, Section 5.5.3.

**Shadowing.** An observation technique where a researcher follows a staff member through their workday to document how they actually perform procedures. See Chapter 3, Section 3.3.1.

**SOP.** Standard Operating Procedure. A focused document that describes how to perform a specific procedure. A MOP contains many SOPs organized into a comprehensive framework.

**Stakeholder Interview.** A structured conversation with a person who has direct knowledge of a procedure or process. Used during the information gathering phase to understand actual practice. See Chapter 3, Section 3.2.

**Time and Motion Study.** A measurement technique that records how long each step in a procedure takes, separating active work time from wait time. Used to set realistic turnaround standards. See Chapter 3, Section 3.3.2.

**Transmittal Memorandum.** A document that accompanies every output delivered to an external party. Provides context, identifies the output, and creates a record of delivery. Also called Form 2 in the PRLS MOP Model. See Chapter 5, Section 5.5.2.

**Triggered Review.** A MOP review initiated by a specific event (new legislation, audit finding, restructuring) outside the regular review schedule. See Chapter 9, Section 9.3.3.

**Turnaround Time.** The total time from receipt of a request to delivery of the completed output. Classified by complexity: Simple (1-2 days), Routine (3-5 days), Complex (6-15 days). See Chapter 7, Section 7.3.

**Version Control.** A system for tracking changes to the MOP. Each version has a number (1.0, 1.1, 2.0) and a change log documenting what changed and who approved the change. See Chapter 9, Section 9.4.3.

**Workflow Table.** See *Four-Column Workflow Table*.

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*Back to Table of Contents*